

CLAT Express - January 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Strike and Legal Debate

United States forces carried out a military strike on Venezuela, known as Operation Absolute Resolve. The strike targeted Caracas, Miranda, Aragua and La Guaira, and it led to the capture of Venezuelan President Nicolas Maduro. Washington justified the action by citing illegal migration, narcotics trafficking and alleged narco-terrorism. Venezuela rejected these claims, arguing that the United States was using migration and drug enforcement narratives to justify regime change. The United States presents its actions as counter-narcotics operations and national security enforcement, which it says gives a legal and political framework to its maritime actions. The action has raised a legal question: can a law enforcement objective justify the use of military force on a sovereign territory? Arguments in favour cite the claim that fentanyl and narco-gangs cause mass American deaths. Opponents warn that crime can become an excuse to violate borders. The United States designated Tren de Aragua and Cartel de los Soles as Foreign Terrorist Organisations, and Washington alleged that Cartel de los Soles operates under the leadership of Maduro. Some sections of Venezuela's domestic opposition have endorsed stronger external pressure, which indirectly supports Washington's interventionist stance. Venezuela has also strengthened partnerships with China, Russia, Iran and Cuba, which the United States views as a challenge to its strategic dominance in the Western Hemisphere. Venezuela says the intervention reflects geopolitical interests rather than genuine concern over migration or narcotics control.

Q1.

The US alleged that Venezuela's 'Cartel of the Suns' collaborated with which Colombian guerrilla group to traffic cocaine into the United States?

- (A) ELN
- (B) Sendero Luminoso
- (C) M-19
- (D) FARC

Q2.

How many core principles did the Monroe Doctrine have?

- (A) One
- (B) Two
- (C) Four
- (D) Three

Q3.

Which of the following statements about the Monroe Doctrine and related policy is/are correct?

- I. The Monroe Doctrine was proclaimed in 1823.
- II. The Roosevelt Corollary expanded the Monroe Doctrine to justify US intervention to maintain stability in the Western Hemisphere.
- III. The Monroe Doctrine was originally designed to encourage European colonisation of the Americas.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Monroe Doctrine	A. January 2019
II. Roosevelt Corollary	B. Articles 233 and 333
III. Maduro's second term	C. 1904
IV. Juan Guaido's declaration	D. 1823

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Venezuela has the world's largest proven crude oil reserves, estimated at over how many billion barrels?

- (A) 100
- (B) 200
- (C) 400
- (D) 300

Q6.

Assertion (A): The Roosevelt Corollary of 1904 allowed European powers to intervene in the Western Hemisphere to maintain stability.

Reason (R): The Monroe Doctrine was expanded through the Roosevelt Corollary to justify US intervention in the Western Hemisphere.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the UN Security Council and related interventions:

- I. The P5 members of the UN Security Council are the US, Russia, China, the UK and France.
- II. Between 2015 and 2024, 47 vetoes blocked 37 draft resolutions.
- III. NATO, AU and ECOWAS intervene only with UNSC approval.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

What position did Juan Guaido hold when he declared himself Acting President?

- (A) Minister of Foreign Affairs
- (B) Vice President
- (C) Governor of Caracas
- (D) Head of National Assembly

Greenland's Status: Practice Set

Greenland is the world's largest island and forms one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, the other being the Faroe Islands. Its relationship with Denmark has a long history. The island became

a Danish colony in the early eighteenth century, after an expedition led by the Danish-Norwegian missionary Hans Egede arrived in 1721. It became a self-governing territory in 1979, and since 2009 it has held the right to declare independence through a referendum. The island's status is now at the centre of a fresh dispute. Denmark's Prime Minister, Mette Frederiksen, has rejected United States claims on Greenland and reaffirmed Danish sovereignty over the Arctic territory. Greenland's place in wider alliances is shaped by Denmark's membership of NATO. Since Denmark is part of the alliance, Greenland is by default part of it as well. Greenland is not a member state of the European Union, but it is associated with the Union as one of the EU Overseas Countries and Territories. As a result, Greenlanders are considered to be EU citizens. Together, its autonomy, its right to independence and its alliance links explain why the island matters to Denmark, Europe and the United States.

Q1.

Which island in Greenland is recognised as the world's northernmost point of land?

- (A) Ellesmere Island
- (B) Nord Island
- (C) Alert Island
- (D) Kaffeklubben Island

Q2.

Assertion (A): Greenland gives the North Atlantic a strategic role in monitoring naval movements.

Reason (R): The GIUK Gap is named after Greenland, Ireland and the United Kingdom.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pituffik Space Base	A. Crucial for semiconductors, renewable energy and defence systems
II. US proposal of 1946	B. Formerly known as Thule Air Base
III. 1951 agreement	C. Offer of \$100 million to Denmark for outright purchase
IV. Rare earth elements	D. US-Denmark Defence Agreement on military access

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

I. Russia has heavily militarised the Arctic coastline.

II. China labels itself a Near-Arctic State.

III. The United States proposed to buy Greenland from Denmark in 1951.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Greenland and the EU:

- I. Greenland joined the European Community together with Denmark in 1973 but left in 1985.
- II. The Anti-Coercion Instrument was designed mainly as a tool for direct military retaliation.
- III. The Transpolar Sea Route is one of the emerging Arctic shipping routes linked to melting ice.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

What name does the booklet give to the EU's Anti-Coercion Instrument?

- (A) Coercion Wall
- (B) Economic Shield
- (C) Strategic Hammer
- (D) Trade Bazooka

Q7.

Which body takes decisions to invite a country to join NATO?

- (A) North Atlantic Council
- (B) United Nations Security Council
- (C) European Commission
- (D) Arctic Council

Q8.

Statement I: Under Article 5, an armed attack on one NATO Ally is treated as an attack on all members.

Statement II: NATO was created by 12 countries on 4 April 1949.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

- (A) Only I
- (B) Only II
- (C) Neither I nor II
- (D) Both I and II

Board of Peace: structure and purpose

The United States has begun the process of forming a new body called the Board of Peace, which is intended to play a part in the future of Gaza. The Board is described as an inter-governmental body led by the United States. It is envisioned as a new international body with a transitional governance role for Gaza after the current conflict. Its design combines elements of international oversight, political coordination and developmental administration. Its proposed mandate includes supervising and guiding the civil administration of Gaza and its security and stabilisation force, mobilising international financial and technical assistance, and ensuring transparency, coordination and accountability during Gaza's transition from conflict to reconstruction. The Board is governed by a charter, which sets out rules on membership, financial contributions and the settlement of disputes. A separate group of global leaders and international figures also supports the arrangement. The arrangement is closely tied to the 20-point peace plan proposed by the United States for ending the war in Gaza. Beyond Gaza, the Board is being presented as a possible template for managing complex global conflicts. Its approach marks a move away from traditional universal multilateral institutions. Such a move raises questions about how institutions like the United Nations should respond to fragmented peacebuilding efforts. Such initiatives are presented as working within existing structures rather than replacing them.

Q1.

Under which UN Security Council resolution was the Board of Peace established?

- (A) Resolution 2803 (2025)
- (B) Resolution 1373 (2001)
- (C) Resolution 184 (1947)
- (D) Resolution 242 (1967)

Q2.

How many Articles does the charter of the Board of Peace contain?

- (A) Seven
- (B) Four
- (C) 20
- (D) 13

Q3.

In which circumstance can the chairman of the Board of Peace be removed?

- (A) If the UN General Assembly votes to remove him
- (B) If two-thirds of member countries request it
- (C) If the US Congress approves it
- (D) Only if he resigns voluntarily or is unanimously declared incapable by the Executive Board

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. High Representative for Gaza	A. 13 Articles
II. Chairman of the NCAG	B. 31 December 2027
III. Initial authorisation of the Board ends	C. Nickolay Mladenov
IV. Number of Articles in the charter	D. Ali Shaath

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Board of Peace:

- I. It is a US-led inter-governmental body established under a UN Security Council resolution.
- II. Its chairman is the US Secretary of State.
- III. Its charter contains 13 Articles.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Gaza plan:

1. All hostages, alive or deceased, must be released within 72 hours of Israel's acceptance of the plan.
2. Hamas members who decommission weapons can receive amnesty or safe passage abroad.
3. Israel is to occupy Gaza permanently under the plan.
4. The plan proposes a special economic zone in Gaza.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

1. A country that joins the Board of Peace must consent to be bound by its charter.
2. The Gaza Executive Board includes a Palestinian representative.

Which statement is correct?

- (A) Only statement 1 is correct
- (B) Only statement 2 is correct
- (C) Both statements are correct
- (D) Neither statement is correct

Chagos Dispute Check

The Chagos Islands have been at the centre of a long dispute between Britain and Mauritius. Before Mauritius became independent, Britain set up the islands as a separate territory, and they stayed under British control after independence. In that period, native Chagossians were forcibly removed from their homes so that a military base could be built on Diego Garcia, the largest island in the archipelago. Mauritius responded through international legal channels. It took the matter to the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague, which found that Britain had violated Mauritius' rights under a major international maritime convention. The ruling also stressed that defence interests had been given priority over Mauritius' rights, and it described Britain's actions as a violation of good faith. Britain, however, insisted that the issue should remain a bilateral matter between the two countries. Mauritius then turned to the United Nations, where the General Assembly voted on a resolution seeking an advisory opinion from the International Court of Justice. The Court later ordered Britain to return the islands to Mauritius. Britain argued that the Court had no jurisdiction over the matter. The dispute reflects a tension between international legal norms on decolonisation and security interests in the Indian Ocean.

Q1.

In which year did the UK declare the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory?

- (A) 1960
- (B) 1970
- (C) 1968
- (D) 1965

Q2.

Between which years were native Chagossians forcibly removed from the islands?

- (A) 1960-1965
- (B) 1965-1970
- (C) 1970-1975
- (D) 1968-1973

Q3.

Under which convention did the Permanent Court of Arbitration rule that the UK had violated Mauritius' rights?

- (A) UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)
- (B) Vienna Convention
- (C) Geneva Convention
- (D) Rome Statute

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Marine Protected Area created around the Chagos Islands	A. 2015
II. Mauritius initiated legal proceedings at the Permanent Court of Arbitration	B. 2017
III. UNGA voted on Mauritius' resolution seeking an ICJ advisory opinion	C. 2019
IV. ICJ ordered the UK to return the Chagos Islands to Mauritius	D. 2010

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UK declared the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory in 1965.
- II. Mauritius gained independence from Britain in 1966.
- III. The ICJ ordered the UK to return the Chagos Islands to Mauritius in 2019.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UK and the US forcibly removed native Chagossians from the islands.
- II. The UN General Assembly voted on Mauritius' resolution in 2015.
- III. The Court found that the UK had ulterior motives in creating a Marine Protected Area around the Chagos Islands.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

In which year did the UN General Assembly vote on Mauritius' resolution to seek an ICJ advisory opinion?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2017

UAE-Saudi rift: practice set

Relations between Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates have come under strain over Yemen, where both countries belong to the anti-Houthi coalition. Saudi military aircraft carried out airstrikes on Mukalla Port in southern Yemen after a consignment arrived from Fujairah in the UAE. Riyadh alleged that the cargo contained arms meant for southern separatist groups. Abu Dhabi rejected this, stating that the shipment consisted of vehicles meant exclusively for UAE forces. Saudi aircraft also struck units of the UAE-supported Southern Transitional Council (STC), with strikes reported in the Hadramout region. The action followed an attempt by Saudi-aligned National Shield Forces to take control of STC military installations, a move the STC strongly opposed. Riyadh then called for STC fighters to withdraw from contested areas, but the group refused. The standoff intensified amid the STC's recent expansion into Hadramout and Mahra, provinces that border Saudi Arabia. Saudi officials described the airstrikes as a preventive and limited intervention meant to avert wider instability. The two governments gave different accounts of the episode. The UAE responded by pulling its troops out of Saudi Arabia. The episode exposes fault lines between two states that share opposition to the Iran-backed Houthi movement, and it complicates prospects for a unified peace process in Yemen.

Q1.

Who became the President of the unified Republic of Yemen in 1990?

- (A) Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi
- (B) Rashad al-Alimi
- (C) Hussein al-Houthi
- (D) Ali Abdullah Saleh

Q2.

Which city is Yemen's capital, currently under Houthi control?

- (A) Aden
- (B) Mukalla
- (C) Hodeidah
- (D) Sanaa

Q3.

According to the UAE, its military presence in Yemen is confined to which activity?

- (A) Nation building
- (B) Political mediation
- (C) Counter-terrorism operations
- (D) Humanitarian assistance

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Southern Transitional Council	A. Captured territory in southern and eastern Yemen at various points
II. Southern Movement (Al-Hirak)	B. Originated among the Zaydi Shia population of northern Yemen
III. Houthi movement	C. Formed in 2007
IV. Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula	D. Advocates autonomy or independence for southern Yemen since 2017

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Until 1990, Yemen existed as two separate countries.
- II. The two Yemeni states merged in 1994 to form the Republic of Yemen.
- III. Ali Abdullah Saleh had governed North Yemen since 1978.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Saudi Arabia asked the UAE to withdraw its military elements from Yemen within 24 hours.
- II. The UAE described its military presence in Yemen as aimed at political mediation.
- III. The Houthis control the north and west of Yemen.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Ansar Allah is the official name of which Yemeni movement?

- (A) Southern Transitional Council
- (B) Southern Movement (Al-Hirak)
- (C) Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula
- (D) Houthi movement

Republic Day Chronology and History

India celebrates Republic Day on 26 January every year to honour the adoption of its Constitution in 1950, which established a sovereign democratic republic. The festivities officially begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. On the day before Republic Day, the President of India delivers the Republic Day Address to the nation. Early on 26 January, the Prime Minister pays homage at the Amar Jawan Jyoti. The President then unfurls the National Flag at Kartavya Path, formerly known as Rajpath,

followed by the National Anthem and a 21-gun salute that marks the formal start of the parade. In the evening, the President confers the Padma and Gallantry Awards. The celebrations conclude on 29 January at Vijay Chowk with the Beating Retreat Ceremony. The history of the day goes back to the Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress in December 1929, which passed the Poorna Swaraj resolution calling for complete independence from British rule. From 1930 to 1947, 26 January was celebrated as Independence Day or Poorna Swaraj Day. India gained independence on 15 August 1947, which led to a re-evaluation of the significance of Republic Day. The Constitution came into effect on 26 January 1950, ending India's status as a Dominion of the British Crown.

Q1.

Who were the Chief Guests for India's Republic Day 2026?

- (A) King of Nepal and Queen Elizabeth II
- (B) President of the United States and Prime Minister of Japan
- (C) Prime Minister of Japan and President of France
- (D) Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa

Q2.

How many honours were conferred under the Padma Awards 2026?

- (A) 131
- (B) 113
- (C) 12
- (D) 70

Q3.

Which award was conferred on Shubhanshu Shukla, the first Indian on the ISS?

- (A) Padma Vibhushan
- (B) Bharat Ratna
- (C) Kirti Chakra
- (D) Ashok Chakra

Q4.

Assertion (A): Gallantry Awards are announced twice a year, on Republic Day and Independence Day.

Reason (R): Wartime Gallantry was instituted on 26 January 1950.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Parakram Divas	A. 29 January
II. Beating Retreat Ceremony	B. 26 November
III. Constitution Day	C. 26 January
IV. Amar Jawan Jyoti homage	D. 23 January

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

- I. Padma Awards are announced annually on the eve of Republic Day.
- II. Wartime Gallantry awards were instituted before Peacetime Gallantry awards.
- III. Gallantry Awards are announced only once a year, on Republic Day.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) II only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 2026 Chief Guests were Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa.
- II. Constitution Day is observed on 26 November.
- III. The Prime Minister unfurls the National Flag on Republic Day.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

On which date was the Declaration of Independence officially promulgated?

- (A) 26 January 1950
- (B) 15 August 1947
- (C) 26 November 1949
- (D) 26 January 1930

Equity Regulations: Provisions and Checks

The University Grants Commission notified the Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions Regulations, 2026 to promote equity, inclusion and anti-discrimination in Indian higher education institutions. The regulations define caste-based discrimination broadly, to include unfair or biased treatment, and cover direct, indirect and systemic discrimination. Their objectives also include preventing discrimination on campuses based on religion, gender, race, disability or place of birth. The central mechanism is the Equal Opportunity Centre, a nodal body for promoting equity and inclusion on campus. Each centre has an Equity Committee that receives and inquires into complaints. The committee includes faculty, non-teaching staff, civil society members and students, with the centre's coordinator acting as member secretary. The committee must convene quickly after a complaint is received and must submit its report within a set number of working days. Unresolved grievances can be appealed to an independent Ombudsperson, whose decisions bind institutions. Accountability is built into the framework. Centres submit bi-annual reports, institutions submit annual equity compliance reports, and a National Monitoring Committee oversees compliance. Heads of institutions are held responsible for compliance, and non-compliance can lead to debarment from UGC schemes, restrictions on offering degrees, or withdrawal of UGC recognition. The framework therefore links every institution to a formal reporting and oversight chain.

Q1.

How many working days are allowed for the Equity Committee to complete its inquiry and submit its report?

- (A) 10 working days
- (B) 12 working days
- (C) 30 working days
- (D) 15 working days

Q2.

How many senior faculty members sit on the Equity Committee as other members?

- (A) 3
- (B) 1
- (C) 2
- (D) 4

Q3.

Which groups does the representation requirement for the Equity Committee cover?

- (A) Only students and faculty members
- (B) Only SC and ST communities
- (C) Only women and students
- (D) SC, ST, OBC, women and persons with disabilities

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Equity Committee must convene within 24 hours of receiving a complaint.

Reason (R): The Head of the institution serves as Chairperson of the Equity Committee.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Convening of Equity Committee after a complaint	A. Two
II. Submission of Equity Committee inquiry report	B. At least twice a year
III. Student representatives on the Equity Committee	C. Within 24 hours
IV. National Monitoring Committee meetings	D. 15 working days

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the 2026 Regulations:

- I. Equal Opportunity Centres are mandatory in all higher education institutions.
- II. The decisions of the Ombudsperson are not binding on institutions.
- III. Institutions submit an annual equity compliance report to UGC.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Equal Opportunity Centres act as a nodal body for promoting equity and inclusion on campus.
- II. The Ombudsperson is a part of the Equity Committee.
- III. Heads of institutions are held responsible for compliance.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Equity Committee's inquiry must be completed within 30 working days.
- II. The National Monitoring Committee meets once every year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Incubation Schemes Check

Support for new businesses in India is organised through several government programmes, and each one has a specific focus. Some programmes provide physical infrastructure to young firms through incubation centres, along with support to help them grow. Other programmes are designed for cities beyond the largest metropolitan areas, where the aim is to open opportunities for entrepreneurs outside major centres. A further group focuses on particular fields, including emerging technologies that are expected to shape future industries. Rural industries and agro-based enterprises are also covered by some schemes. Several of these programmes connect startups with mentors and networks, which helps founders gain practical guidance. Programmes differ in how they are delivered: some work through physical centres, some through online platforms and some through funding or guarantees. Together these programmes show that innovation is meant to spread widely rather than remain confined to a few cities or sectors. Students should note that every programme has a distinct purpose, a target group and a full name that explains its work. Knowing the expansion of each acronym, and the place or sector each one serves, is essential for answering precise questions on this topic. Read each scheme with its objective and its region of focus in mind.

Q1.

What does GENESIS stand for?

- (A) Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups
- (B) Gen-Next Support for Innovation Startups
- (C) Generation Support for Innovative Startups
- (D) Gen-Next System for Innovative Startups

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Atal Innovation Mission establishes Atal Incubation Centres.
- II. GENESIS focuses on startups in metropolitan cities.
- III. NIDHI aims at socio-economic growth through wealth and job creation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q3.

Under which body does the Atal Innovation Mission operate?

- (A) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (B) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (C) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- (D) NITI Aayog

Q4.

Which scheme sets up a network of technology centres and incubation centres to promote agro-industry startups?

- (A) ASPIRE
- (B) GENESIS
- (C) NIDHI
- (D) TIDE 2.0

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. GENESIS	A. Technology-driven ideas into successful startups
II. ASPIRE	B. Startups in Tier-II and Tier-III cities
III. NIDHI	C. Startups in AI, IoT and Blockchain
IV. TIDE 2.0	D. Network of technology and incubation centres for agro-industry

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. TIDE 2.0 supports startups in emerging technologies such as AI, IoT and Blockchain.
- II. GENESIS was launched in 2016.
- III. ASPIRE stands for A Scheme for Promotion of Innovation, Rural Industries and Entrepreneurship.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Which scheme aims at socio-economic growth through wealth and job creation?

- (A) ASPIRE
- (B) TIDE 2.0
- (C) GENESIS
- (D) NIDHI

India-EU FTA: CLAT Practice

India and the European Union have concluded a free trade agreement that is widely described as a landmark in their economic relationship. The deal was finalised at the 16th India-EU Summit held in New Delhi, and it is expected to create an economic space covering around two billion people. It brings to a close a long series of talks that began in 2007, were suspended for a period, and were later revived. Before the deal can be fully implemented, it still needs to be ratified by the Indian Parliament and by European bodies.

The agreement is also a response to a changing global trade environment. Supply chain disruptions and rising protectionism have pushed India to diversify its trade partnerships, and the deal is seen as a way to reduce dependence on a single market. Both sides have kept comprehensive negative lists for sensitive farm commodities, so that rural livelihoods and food security are protected. A parallel agreement on geographical indications is meant to stop the unauthorised use of iconic products in either market.

The European Union itself is a political and economic union of member states. Its institutions include an executive body that proposes laws and manages the budget, a legislature that shares lawmaking duties, a council of heads of state or government, and a court that ensures EU law is applied uniformly. The EU has also introduced a carbon levy on certain imports, a measure that India views with concern as a possible form of green protectionism.

Q1.

What was the total bilateral trade between India and the EU in 2024-25?

- (A) \$126.53 billion
- (B) \$130.53 billion
- (C) \$146.53 billion
- (D) \$136.53 billion

Q2.

Consider the following:

Assertion (A): Indian labour-intensive exporters are expected to gain significantly in the EU market.

Reason (R): The EU will eliminate customs duties on 99.5% of Indian exports, and labour-intensive goods such as textiles now enter the EU at 0% duty.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. EU duty elimination on Indian exports	A. 110%
II. Pre-reduction tariff on cars above EUR 15,000	B. 250,000 units
III. Annual tariff rate quota for these cars	C. 44%
IV. Maximum current Indian tariff on machinery	D. 99.5%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the India-EU FTA:

- I. India will phase out tariffs on over 90% of EU goods.
- II. Dairy, wheat, rice and poultry are inside India's tariff reduction framework.
- III. The EU has exempted beef, sugar and rice from its own tariff cuts.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM):

- I. The transitional phase from 2023 to 2025 carried no financial levy.
- II. Textiles and apparel are among the sectors covered by CBAM.
- III. Importers must buy CBAM certificates linked to the embedded carbon in goods.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

How many Commissioners does the European Commission have?

- (A) 27
- (B) 26
- (C) 28
- (D) 25

Q7.

Which EU institution is the only elected legislative body?

- (A) European Parliament
- (B) European Council
- (C) Court of Justice of the EU
- (D) European Central Bank

Q8.

From what date does the full CBAM carbon levy on imports apply?

- (A) 1 January 2025
- (B) 1 July 2026
- (C) 1 January 2027
- (D) 1 January 2026

Birth Control Policy in China

China's approach to family size has changed several times since the Mao era. In the early phase, birth control existed under Mao Zedong, but it was not a major policy priority. Later, the government's five-year plans began promoting birth control, and in some cases the measures used were coercive. A strict limit on family size was then introduced, and this limit was relaxed in stages over the following decades. The relaxation did not bring fertility back to earlier levels. Women now have higher education and employment, which has enhanced their autonomy over reproductive decisions and contributed to delayed childbirth. Changing social attitudes, economic pressures and high urban living costs and housing pressures are also among the factors linked to the trend. Many young people delay marriage and childbirth because of job competition and work-life stress. Economic and social barriers also prevent many couples from having the number of children they desire. Smaller families, in turn, can disrupt traditional support systems for the elderly. The COVID-19 pandemic further accelerated the decline. Overall, the experience shows how policy changes alone may not reverse deep-rooted behavioural patterns in a population.

Q1.

In which years did the Great Leap Forward occur in China?

- (A) 1958-1962
- (B) 1955-1960
- (C) 1960-1965
- (D) 1962-1967

Q2.

Which slogan was promoted in China's birth control push of the 1970s?

- (A) Small Family, Happy Family
- (B) One Child, One Nation
- (C) Quality over Quantity
- (D) Later, Longer, Fewer

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Great Leap Forward (1958-62)	A. Slogan encouraging delayed marriage and births
II. Later, Longer, Fewer	B. Further relaxation of birth limits
III. One-Child Policy (1980)	C. Famine and millions of deaths
IV. Three-Child Policy (2021)	D. Restricted most couples to a single child

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

- I. China's total fertility rate was 1.3 births per woman in the 2020 Census.
- II. Population growth rebounded after the Great Leap Forward was rolled back.
- III. China's Three-Child Policy was introduced in 2016.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q5.

How many of the following statements about China's population policy are correct?

- I. The slogan 'Later, Longer, Fewer' encouraged longer intervals between births.
- II. The One-Child Policy was formally introduced in 1975.
- III. China's TFR was 2.75 in 1979.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

- I. The Great Leap Forward aimed to boost production and living standards.
- II. Population growth rebounded during the Great Leap Forward.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

BBNJ and the law of the seas

The world's oceans are divided into zones with very different legal status. Near a coast, a state has full sovereignty over its territorial sea, and its exclusive economic zone gives it the right to exploit economic resources. Further out lie spaces that belong to no single country. These spaces, known as areas beyond national jurisdiction, cover the high seas and the international seabed area. They are described as global commons and are open to all states for activities such as navigation, overflight and the laying of submarine cables and pipelines. Taken together, these areas make up a large share of the world's ocean surface, so their governance is a serious concern. The main legal framework for all ocean activities is the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea, often called the constitution for the oceans. Within that framework, a newer treaty was negotiated

to protect biodiversity in areas beyond national jurisdiction. Its negotiations took place under a United Nations conference devoted to marine biodiversity in these areas. The new treaty is significant because it is the first global legal framework of its kind for protecting ocean biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction. It sits alongside the 1994 agreement on deep seabed mining and the 1995 UN Fish Stocks Agreement as part of the Convention's framework. Its goals also support wider global commitments on nature conservation, so it is closely tied to international biodiversity efforts.

Q1.

How many countries have ratified the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) 63
- (B) 73
- (C) 83
- (D) 93

Q2.

What is India's status regarding the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) Signed, ratification pending
- (B) Ratified
- (C) Not signed
- (D) Rejected

Q3.

Assertion (A): Coastal states have full sovereignty over the high seas.

Reason (R): The high seas are free for navigation by vessels of all nations.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. BBNJ Agreement adopted	A. 30%
II. Countries that have ratified BBNJ	B. 2023
III. Land and sea protection target by 2030	C. 4
IV. Number of pillars of BBNJ	D. 83

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the BBNJ Agreement:

- I. It was adopted in 2023.
- II. India has ratified it.
- III. The Conference of the Parties is its decision-making body.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the BBNJ Agreement are correct?

- I. It was adopted in 2023.
- II. It has been ratified by 83 countries.
- III. It has five pillars.
- IV. India has ratified it.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT one of the four pillars of the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) Marine Genetic Resources
- (B) Environmental Impact Assessments
- (C) Capacity Building and Technology Transfer
- (D) Climate Change Mitigation

Q8.

Which target is mentioned for the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework that the BBNJ Agreement supports?

- (A) 30% of land and sea by 2030
- (B) 20% of land and sea by 2025
- (C) 40% of land and sea by 2035
- (D) 50% of land and sea by 2040

PSLV-C62 mission check

ISRO planned its first launch of 2026 with PSLV-C62, a rocket scheduled to lift off from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh. The Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle is often called the workhorse of ISRO, and this flight carried a mix of government and commercial satellites. During the mission, a fault appeared in the third stage. A solid rocket anomaly disrupted the high-thrust delivery to the upper stages, and this affected the planned injection of the satellites into orbit. The failure came after an earlier setback with PSLV-C61, which put the vehicle under close scrutiny.

Among the payloads was EOS-N1, also known as Anvesha, an Earth observation satellite built for strategic applications. Another payload was KID, a small re-entry prototype developed by a Spanish startup, which was meant to splash down in the ocean. The flight also carried AayulSAT, a satellite refuelling payload from a Bengaluru company, and a group of co-passenger satellites from several countries. Together, the payloads covered Earth observation, re-entry testing and satellite refuelling. Each payload was carried on the same rocket, so a fault in the upper stages put all of them at risk. The rocket's earlier flights, including missions to the Moon and Mars, show why its reliability matters for the national programme.

Q1.

How many months passed between the PSLV-C61 setback and the PSLV-C62 failure? (in months)

- (A) 8 months
- (B) 6 months
- (C) 10 months
- (D) 12 months

Q2.

Which organisation developed the EOS-N1 (Anvesha) satellite?

- (A) ISRO
- (B) HAL
- (C) DRDO
- (D) BARC

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anvesha (EOS-N1)	A. First on-orbit satellite refuelling payload
II. Kestrel Initial Demonstrator	B. Liquid propellant second stage of PSLV
III. AayulSAT	C. Small-scale re-entry vehicle prototype
IV. Vikas engine	D. Hyperspectral imaging satellite

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q4.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- I. PSLV was first launched in 1993.
- II. PSLV uses liquid propellants in its first and third stages.
- III. PSLV can carry up to 1750 kg to a 600 km Sun-synchronous orbit.

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about PSLV-C62 and its payloads are correct?

- A. The launch was scheduled from Sriharikota.
- B. The KID prototype was developed in India.
- C. A total of 104 satellites flew on PSLV-C62.
- D. AayulSAT was developed by a Bengaluru-based company.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

Which PSLV flight carried Aditya-L1 into space?

- (A) PSLV-C57
- (B) PSLV-C58
- (C) PSLV-C62
- (D) PSLV-C61

Q7.

Which Bengaluru-based company developed AayulSAT?

- (A) Agnikul Cosmos
- (B) Skyroot Aerospace
- (C) Pixxel Space
- (D) OrbitAID Aerospace

Governance Act practice set

The National Sports Governance Act and its rules mark a major change in how sports are run in India. The key institutional mechanisms came into force in January 2026, after the Union Government notified the National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026. The reforms aim to make sports administration more transparent, inclusive and accountable. At the centre of the system is an apex regulatory body that decides which national sports bodies remain recognised, and it keeps a central register of those bodies. Elections in sports federations will be overseen by a panel drawn from experienced former election officials, so that long-standing problems of conflict of interest and factionalism can be addressed. Disputes about athlete selection, elections and governance will go to a separate tribunal, which is meant to resolve cases independently, speedily and at a reasonable cost. Doping-related matters follow a different legal route. Every national sports body must also have a general body and an executive committee; the general body must include sportspersons and the executive committee must include women. The reforms are meant to curb politicisation, arbitrary decisions and the lack of accountability in sports administration. Beyond governance, the government runs programmes that encourage fitness, identify young talent and support athletes who aim to win medals at the Olympics.

Q1.

Assertion (A): Appeals against National Sports Tribunal decisions lie only before the Supreme Court.

Reason (R): The National Sports Tribunal is headed by a sitting or retired Supreme Court Judge or Chief Justice of a High Court.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Olympic Committee	A. Established in 2005
II. National Paralympic Committee	B. Sole governing body for Olympic sports in India
III. Court of Arbitration for Sport	C. Sole governing body for Paralympic sports
IV. National Anti-Doping Agency	D. Established in 1984 by the IOC

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Sports Election Panel must have at least 20 members at all times.
- II. Recognised sports bodies are deemed public authorities under the RTI Act 2005.
- III. The appellate authority for National Sports Tribunal decisions is the High Court.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Search-cum-Selection Committee of the National Sports Board:

- I. It is chaired by the Cabinet Secretary.
- II. It includes two recipients of National Sports Awards.
- III. It includes the Secretary of the Ministry of Finance.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q5.

What is the minimum number of Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit required in the General Body of every National Sports Body?

- (A) 2
- (B) 6
- (C) 4
- (D) 8

Q6.

In which year was the National Anti-Doping Agency set up?

- (A) 2001
- (B) 2008
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2005

Q7.

Who is the youngest Indian to win an individual Olympic medal?

- (A) Manu Bhaker
- (B) Praveen Kumar
- (C) Aman Sehrawat
- (D) D Gukesh

Q8.

How many other members besides the head does the National Sports Tribunal have?

- (A) 2
- (B) 1
- (C) 3
- (D) 4

UN and Control Regimes Check

The United Nations Security Council is one of the six principal organs of the United Nations and was established in 1945 under the UN Charter. Its main purpose is maintaining international peace

and security. It addresses countries that threaten global security, authorises peacekeeping missions and imposes sanctions. In cases of international conflict, it can also authorise the use of force. The Council has fifteen members. Five of them are permanent members: China, France, Russia, the United States and the United Kingdom. The other ten are non-permanent members, and the General Assembly elects five of them each year for a two-year term. These ten seats are distributed on a regional basis. The Council's headquarters are in New York City. Several arrangements outside the Council work to limit the spread of dangerous weapons. The Australia Group was founded in 1985 in response to the use of chemical weapons during the Iran-Iraq War, and it works to prevent the proliferation of chemical and biological weapons. Three export control regimes also operate in this field: the Nuclear Suppliers Group, the Missile Technology Control Regime and the Wassenaar Arrangement. Each of these bodies is a separate arrangement with its own membership and purpose. The booklet presents these as part of the wider international effort against weapons proliferation.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty was extended indefinitely in 1995.
- II. North Korea remains a member of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) Neither I nor II
- (B) I only
- (C) II only
- (D) Both I and II

Q2.

- I. The Missile Technology Control Regime was set up in 1987 to prevent the spread of missile and drone technology.
- II. The Australia Group has 42 member countries along with the European Union.
- III. The Wassenaar Arrangement was set up before the Missile Technology Control Regime.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Assertion (A): The guidelines of the Australia Group are legally binding on all its members.

Reason (R): The Australia Group is an informal multilateral arrangement and is not legally binding.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (C) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the UN Security Council are correct?

- I. The Council's presidency rotates among its 15 members every month.
- II. The Security Council itself elects the five non-permanent members each year.
- III. India served as a non-permanent member seven times before its 2021-22 term.
- IV. Germany is one of the prime movers of the Coffee Club.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Nuclear Suppliers Group	A. Controls conventional arms and dual-use goods
II. Missile Technology Control Regime	B. Classifies states by nuclear status as of 1 January 1967
III. Wassenaar Arrangement	C. Prevents spread of missile and drone technology
IV. Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty	D. Regulates nuclear-related exports

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

In which year did India join the Australia Group?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 1996
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2021

Q7.

Which country is one of the prime movers of the Coffee Club, a group that opposes expansion of permanent seats on the UNSC?

- (A) Brazil
- (B) Japan
- (C) Germany
- (D) Italy

Q8.

In which year was the Wassenaar Arrangement established?

- (A) 1996
- (B) 1975
- (C) 1987
- (D) 1985

Sanctions and Strategic Interests

Venezuela has been at the centre of a sharp dispute with Washington. After Juan Guaido declared himself Acting President, tensions with Washington rose further. Caracas reacted sharply to these developments. The United States then imposed sanctions on the state-owned oil firm, which is central to the country's economy. Venezuela holds some of the largest oil reserves in the world, so the dispute has a strong energy dimension. Venezuela has also built relationships with several governments outside the region, and Washington has watched these ties closely. Caracas has rejected the allegations made against it, arguing that they are used to justify a change of government. Caracas also says that migration and drug issues are being used as a cover for political goals. Economic pressure has become a central feature of the dispute, shaping how both governments describe their goals and the steps they take next. Venezuela's economy has suffered deep problems in recent years, including high inflation and power outages. Shortages of food and problems in healthcare have added to the strain on ordinary citizens. Nicolas Maduro has led the government through these years, and critics have questioned the fairness of recent elections. Caracas and Washington give very different accounts of the dispute and its causes.

Q1.

According to the booklet, the sanctions on the state-owned oil firm aimed to cut Maduro's access to which source of income?

- (A) Foreign loans
- (B) Tourism income
- (C) Oil revenue
- (D) Military aid

Q2.

Assertion (A): Venezuela's partnerships with China, Russia, Iran and Cuba cover energy, defence and finance.

Reason (R): The US views these alignments as a challenge to its strategic dominance in the Western Hemisphere.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maduro's retaliation for US recognition of Guaido	A. Unilateral and transactional diplomacy over multilateralism
II. US response after sanctions failed to dislodge Maduro	B. Counter-narcotics operations and national security enforcement
III. Preferred style of US diplomacy	C. Maritime interdictions aimed at choking oil revenues
IV. Legal banner for US maritime actions	D. Severed diplomatic ties and expelled American diplomats

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the US-Venezuela dispute:

- I. Sections of Venezuela's domestic opposition have endorsed stronger external pressure.
- II. Venezuela's partnerships with China, Russia, Iran and Cuba are limited to defence ties.
- III. Sanctions drastically limited Venezuela's oil exports to the US.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The US has treated the Caribbean as a critical zone of influence.
 - II. Sanctions drastically increased Venezuela's oil exports to the US.
 - III. Venezuela's economy suffered a drastic contraction, largely blamed on corruption, poor governance and overdependence on oil.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q6.

According to the booklet, gaining leverage over Venezuela's large oil reserves could help the US do what?

- (A) Reduce dependence on West Asian oil
- (B) Increase dependence on Russian gas
- (C) Expand membership of OPEC
- (D) Halt all maritime operations

Q7.

According to the booklet, which US President officially recognised Juan Guaido as Venezuela's legitimate leader?

- (A) Barack Obama
- (B) George W. Bush
- (C) Donald Trump
- (D) Joe Biden

Monroe Doctrine and the UN

It was announced by an American president in the early nineteenth century, when European powers were looking to expand their presence in Latin America. The doctrine's early history is closely linked to the period after the Napoleonic wars. Its first purpose was defensive, but the doctrine was later used to justify American intervention in the region. The Roosevelt Corollary of 1904 extended the doctrine, stating that the United States could act to keep stability in the Western Hemisphere. The United Nations was created to maintain international peace and security, yet it has very often struggled to stop unilateral military action by states. Some states have redefined the use of force as law enforcement or preventive self-defence. The Security Council is the body at the very centre of these efforts. Modern conflicts increasingly involve many hidden methods that blur the line between peace and war, and such conflicts are often described as gray-zone conflicts. Reform proposals have been put forward to make the Security Council more effective and more accountable.

Q1.

Which Monroe Doctrine principle states that European powers must not establish new colonies in the Americas?

- (A) Non-intervention
- (B) Collective security
- (C) Free trade
- (D) Non-colonisation

Q2.

Assertion (A): The UN Security Council has struggled to prevent unilateral military interventions.

Reason (R): P5 members can block any Security Council resolution.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. NotPetya attack	A. Stopping European re-colonisation of Latin America
II. Original aim of the Monroe Doctrine	B. Binding gray-zone accountability protocol
III. Power of P5 members	C. Cyberattack that disrupted global systems
IV. Reform for gray-zone threats	D. Can block any UN Security Council resolution

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Regional organisations such as NATO, the AU and ECOWAS intervene without UN Security Council approval.
- II. A veto override for mass atrocities is among the reform ideas discussed.
- III. The Monroe Doctrine was originally designed to encourage European colonisation of Latin America.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The UN faces unpaid regular dues from its members.
 - II. The P5 members are the US, Russia, China, UK and France.
 - III. The UN Security Council has no permanent members.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which set of tactics does the booklet list for modern gray-zone conflicts?

- (A) Cyberattacks, private military companies and proxies
- (B) Naval blockades and trade embargoes
- (C) Nuclear tests and missile launches
- (D) Diplomatic summits and treaties

Q7.

During the Cold War, the Monroe Doctrine was used for what purpose?

- (A) To expand European colonies in Africa
- (B) To promote UN peacekeeping missions
- (C) To counter Soviet influence in the Americas
- (D) To fund NATO expansion in Asia

US Ties with Greenland: MCQ

Greenland is the world's largest island and one of two autonomous territories belonging to Denmark. Because Denmark is a member of NATO, Greenland is by default part of the North Atlantic Military Alliance. The island lies between North America and Europe, which places it at the centre of the security arrangements that link the two continents across the Arctic and the Atlantic. Greenland is described as a linchpin in Arctic and trans-Atlantic security architecture. Its location has also drawn sustained attention from the United States, and relations between Washington and Copenhagen over the island have a long history. Greenland's position also has a broader geostrategic dimension, since it sits between the Arctic and the Atlantic. Denmark's Prime Minister has rejected US claims about Greenland and reaffirmed Danish sovereignty over the territory. Greenland became a self-governing territory in 1979, and its colonial history began after an expedition led by Hans Egede arrived in 1721. Greenland has held the right to declare independence through a referendum since 2009. The island's strategic value rests on its geography, its history and its role in alliance security. For that reason, the island remains a subject of close interest to governments operating in the Arctic and the North Atlantic.

Q1.

During which war did the United States seize temporary control of Greenland?

- (A) The First World War
- (B) The Korean War
- (C) The Second World War
- (D) The Cold War

Q2.

The United States seized temporary control of Greenland to stop which country from exploiting the Danish colony?

- (A) Nazi Germany
- (B) Imperial Japan
- (C) Soviet Union
- (D) Fascist Italy

Q3.

Greenland hosts critical infrastructure for which US system?

- (A) Deep Sea Surveillance System
- (B) Global Weather Monitoring Grid
- (C) Undersea Cable Protection Network
- (D) Ballistic Missile Early-Warning System

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 1946	A. Defence agreement formalising American military access
II. 1951	B. Facility for monitoring potential missile threats
III. GIUK Gap	C. US offer of \$100 million to Denmark for outright purchase of Greenland
IV. Pituffik Space Base	D. Key chokepoint for monitoring naval movements in the North Atlantic

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Greenland's strategic links:

- I. Greenland enhances NATO's ability to monitor Russian activities in the Arctic and North Atlantic.
- II. The 1951 defence agreement was signed between the United States and Russia.
- III. The United States maintains Pituffik Space Base on Greenland.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about Greenland are correct?

- I. The US seized temporary control of Greenland during the Cold War.
- II. Pituffik Space Base helps monitor potential missile threats from Russia, China and North Korea.
- III. The 1951 defence agreement formalised American military access to Greenland.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Great Power Competition and ACI: MCQ

The Arctic has become a region of growing interest for major powers. Melting ice is opening new maritime corridors, and control over these sea lanes will shape future global trade and naval power projection. The new routes could reduce travel time between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans, and they could lower fuel and shipping costs. Greenland lies between North America and Europe, within the Arctic and North Atlantic region, and it is described as a linchpin in Arctic and trans-Atlantic security architecture. Denmark is a member of NATO, so Greenland is by default part of the alliance. Greenland is one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, alongside the Faroe Islands. The island's untapped rare earth reserves are important for semiconductors, renewable energy technologies and defence systems. The European Union has a legal mechanism for situations in which a non-EU country pressures the bloc or its member states. The mechanism is designed for use when such pressure persists, and disputes are meant to be resolved through dialogue first. Escalation is considered only if necessary. Greenland joined the European Community together with Denmark in 1973 but left it in 1985, and the EU has since replaced that community. Greenlanders are considered EU citizens. Greenland is also the world's largest island

and a self-governing territory of Denmark.

Q1.

Which country has heavily militarised its Arctic coastline?

- (A) Canada
- (B) Norway
- (C) Iceland
- (D) Russia

Q2.

A French President urged the EU to invoke the Anti-Coercion Instrument for the first time against tariffs imposed by which country?

- (A) United States
- (B) China
- (C) Russia
- (D) Denmark

Q3.

Under the Anti-Coercion Instrument, a non-EU country's measures must affect which two areas for the EU to respond?

- (A) Trade and investment
- (B) Tourism and education
- (C) Defence and intelligence
- (D) Fisheries and mining

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Trade Measures	A. Restrictions on foreign direct investment
II. Investment Measures	B. Limiting access to the EU internal market
III. Market Access	C. Measures affecting intellectual property rights, public procurement and services
IV. IP & Services	D. Import/export restrictions on goods and services

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Greenland and the strategic environment:

- I. China is investing in Arctic research and infrastructure.
- II. The Anti-Coercion Instrument is primarily a tool for military retaliation.
- III. Denmark's firm stance highlights tensions between territorial sovereignty and the strategic ambitions of major powers.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the EU's Anti-Coercion Instrument are correct?

- I. Its objectives include protecting the EU's strategic autonomy.
 - II. It responds when a country within the EU coerces another EU member.
 - III. It aims to deter economic coercion.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

US 20-point Gaza plan: features

The Gaza war began in 2023. The United States has put forward a 20-point plan to end the war in Gaza. The plan carries the official title Comprehensive Plan to End the Gaza Conflict. It followed talks between President Donald Trump and Israel's Prime Minister, Benjamin Netanyahu. The main aim is to bring the fighting to an end and to build a stable future for Gaza and its people. The plan describes Gaza's future in broad terms, and it sets out a sequence of steps for both sides to take. Essential goods are to reach the territory without delay, and damaged infrastructure is to be rebuilt. The economy is also to be revived, with jobs created and the region rebuilt as a place to live and work. The points cover security, aid, governance and reconstruction, and together they form one framework. Political arrangements form another part of the design. Day-to-day civil administration would pass to a temporary body of Palestinians working under a wider international board. The plan also points towards self-determination and statehood for Palestinians, and the United States is to lead talks on a peaceful political future between Israelis and Palestinians. Each part of the framework is set out in a numbered point in the plan.

Q1.

According to the plan, the special economic zone for Gaza is to be supported by which source?

- (A) Religious endowments from neighbouring states
- (B) Proceeds from regional oil exports
- (C) International investment
- (D) A tax on goods entering the territory

Q2.

What does the plan say about the freedom of Gaza's residents to remain or move?

- (A) They are free to stay, leave or return
- (B) They must remain in place until reconstruction ends
- (C) They are moved to designated camps
- (D) They are required to leave during reconstruction

Q3.

Which force is to be deployed to secure Gaza and train its police?

- (A) Israeli Defence Forces
- (B) UN Peacekeeping Force
- (C) International Stabilization Force
- (D) Arab League Monitoring Mission

Q4.

Assertion (A): The plan gives Hamas a role in governing Gaza after the war.

Reason (R): Hamas is excluded from governance under the plan.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Interfaith dialogue platform	A. Favourable trade terms
II. Special economic zone	B. Reopens under agreement
III. Hamas members who decommission weapons	C. Promotes religious harmony
IV. Rafah crossing	D. Amnesty or safe passage abroad

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the US 20-point plan for Gaza:

- I. Gaza is to become a demilitarised, terror-free zone.
- II. Israeli forces are to withdraw as stability and demilitarisation progress.
- III. The plan requires all Palestinian prisoners to remain in detention.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the plan's terms:

- I. Israel is to free 250 Palestinian life-sentence prisoners.
- II. Israel is to occupy Gaza permanently under the plan.
- III. All hostages, alive or deceased, must be released within 72 hours of Israel's formal acceptance.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Board of Peace: UN reform and significance

A current affairs account treats reform of the United Nations system as urgent. Its argument begins with efforts to rebuild societies after conflict. Peacebuilding efforts often suffer from fragmentation and a loss of institutional continuity. In this setting, the Board of Peace is introduced as a US-led intergovernmental body with a transitional role in post-conflict Gaza. It works alongside the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza and the International Stabilization Force, supervising them and mobilising financial and technical assistance. The Board is also described as a new international body with its own charter, which covers membership rules, financial contributions and dispute redressal. Membership requires countries to consent to be bound by the charter. Membership can be rotational, and permanent membership is also available. Its stated objectives include transparency, coordination and accountability during Gaza's transition from conflict to reconstruction. Gaza's reconstruction is to be supported through a special economic zone with favourable trade terms. A Gaza Executive Board, described as a supporting operational body, coordinates activities on the ground. Day-to-day civil administration is handled by a committee of politically independent Palestinian technocrats. The plan also includes an interfaith dialogue platform. The wider dispute has a long history, and Britain was granted a mandate over

Palestine after the First World War.

Q1.

What has the prolonged deadlock over comprehensive UN Security Council reform done?

- (A) Expanded the veto powers of permanent members
- (B) Ended all UN peacekeeping missions
- (C) Made the General Assembly the sole decision-maker
- (D) Paralysed timely action

Q2.

What does the Board of Peace aim to institutionalise?

- (A) Short-term military deployments
- (B) Annual summits of regional leaders
- (C) Permanent UN peacekeeping quotas
- (D) Long-term political engagement

Q3.

How does the booklet describe the Board's innovation within the UN system?

- (A) A revolutionary replacement of existing bodies
- (B) A regional security alliance
- (C) An incremental innovation within existing structures
- (D) A purely humanitarian relief agency

Q4.

Assertion (A): The General Assembly can establish subsidiary bodies without amending the UN Charter.

Reason (R): Article 22 of the UN Charter gives the General Assembly this power.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ad hoc peacebuilding missions	A. Rapid decision-making over consensus-based diplomacy
II. The Board of Peace	B. Preventing relapse into conflict
III. The Board's stated purpose	C. Reform from within, not replacement
IV. The Board's decision-making style	D. End once immediate crises subside

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements on the Board's role and design:

- I. The Board of Peace is presented as a replacement for the UN Security Council.
- II. The Board is said to signal evolving US thinking on conflict resolution.
- III. The Board is projected as a template for managing complex global conflicts.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Board's approach to global governance:

- I. The Board represents a move towards mini-lateral, leader-centric mechanisms.
- II. The Board emphasises consensus-based diplomacy over rapid decision-making.
- III. UN peacebuilding missions often continue long after immediate crises subside.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Chagos Sovereignty Deal and the Diego Garcia Base

Britain has agreed to transfer sovereignty of the Chagos Islands to Mauritius. The UK and Mauritius reached this agreement, and the UK ceded its claims over the archipelago. The arrangement is not a complete handover, because the UK keeps sovereign rights over Diego Garcia, where a joint UK-US military base is located. Under the agreement, the base will remain operational for an initial period. The Chagos Islands are an archipelago in the Indian Ocean. The United States has raised concerns about the arrangement. Washington sees a change in sovereignty as a matter that could affect its strategic position, and that concern is part of a wider debate. The issue pits decolonisation against security interests. It also reflects a tension between international legal norms and realpolitik. Geopolitics adds another layer. Competition in the Indian Ocean region involves China, the United States and other regional powers. The UK has insisted that the issue should remain a bilateral matter. In 2015, Mauritius began legal proceedings against the UK at the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague, challenging the UK's sovereignty claims and the forced removal of Chagossians. Mauritius is an island nation located in the Western Indian Ocean, and India has backed Mauritius's territorial claim over the archipelago.

Q1.

Which US President criticised the UK's plan to transfer the Chagos Islands to Mauritius?

- (A) Donald Trump
- (B) Joe Biden
- (C) Barack Obama
- (D) Boris Johnson

Q2.

For how long will the joint UK-US base at Diego Garcia remain operational for an initial period?

- (A) 50 years
- (B) 75 years
- (C) 99 years
- (D) 125 years

Q3.

How many islands make up the Chagos archipelago?

- (A) 38
- (B) 48
- (C) 52
- (D) 58

Q4.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): The US has raised concerns that a change in sovereignty could affect base security.

Reason (R): Under the agreement, the UK retains sovereign rights over Diego Garcia.

Which option is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (C) A is true but R is false.
- (D) A is false but R is true.

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Donald Trump	A. Largest island of the Chagos archipelago
II. Joint UK-US base	B. Comprises 58 islands
III. Diego Garcia	C. Criticised the UK plan
IV. Chagos Islands	D. Operational for an initial period of 99 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. Diego Garcia is located in the Central Indian Ocean.

II. The Chagos archipelago comprises 58 islands.

III. The US has welcomed the UK plan without any reservation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

I. Trump criticised the UK's plan to transfer the Chagos Islands.

II. Diego Garcia is the smallest island of the Chagos archipelago.

III. The initial period for the base is 75 years.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only one

Colonial Passage of the Chagos Islands

The Chagos Islands are an archipelago in the Indian Ocean, and their history has been shaped by the European powers that controlled them. The islands were first reached by European sailors, and for a period they were under the control of a European power other than Britain. The turning point came when Britain took control of both the Chagos Islands and Mauritius, following a major conflict in Europe. Under the arrangements that followed, the islands passed into British hands. Britain later declared the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory. Mauritius later argued that it had been coerced into giving up the islands during its colonial period. It pointed to a UN resolution that prohibited the breakup of colonies before independence. The UK, in turn, argued that the matter lay outside the reach of the body that had been asked to decide it. Mauritius later gained independence from British rule, and the dispute over the islands has a long history. Since then, the dispute has been pursued through legal action by Mauritius, and India has backed Mauritius's territorial claim over the Chagos Islands. Mauritius is an island nation located in the Western Indian Ocean. Today the dispute is between the UK and Mauritius.

Q1.

In which century were the Chagos Islands first discovered by European navigators?

- (A) 14th century
- (B) 15th century
- (C) 16th century
- (D) 18th century

Q2.

After whose defeat did Britain take control of both the Chagos Islands and Mauritius?

- (A) Napoleon
- (B) Louis XIV
- (C) Bismarck
- (D) Frederick the Great

Q3.

In which year did France cede the Chagos Islands to Britain?

- (A) 1714
- (B) 1914
- (C) 1814
- (D) 1614

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Portuguese navigators	A. Claimed the ICJ had no jurisdiction over the matter
II. France	B. Prohibited the breakup of colonies before independence
III. UN Resolution 1514	C. Discovered the Chagos Islands in the 16th century
IV. The UK's argument in the case	D. Ceded the islands to Britain in 1814

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Chagos Islands came under French control after Portuguese navigators discovered them.
- II. The UK argued that the International Court of Justice had jurisdiction over the matter.
- III. Mauritius gained independence from British rule in 1814.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I only

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Napoleon's defeat led to Britain taking control of Chagos and Mauritius.
- II. France ceded the Chagos Islands to Britain in 1914.
- III. UN Resolution 1314 prohibited the breakup of colonies before independence.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only three

MAHASAGAR and Maritime Initiatives

MAHASAGAR is an initiative launched by the Indian Navy. It is an expanded framework that builds upon India's earlier maritime doctrine. While that doctrine primarily addressed India's immediate maritime neighbourhood, MAHASAGAR widens its scope to a broader group of countries. The key focus areas of the initiative are trade for development, mutual security, technology sharing and financial assistance. The initiative convenes naval chiefs and maritime officials from littoral states, including Bangladesh, Comoros, Kenya, Madagascar and Maldives. One of the new tools under the initiative is a platform called IOS Sagar, which is meant to deepen naval cooperation with Indian Ocean littorals. The platform focuses on humanitarian assistance, disaster relief and joint security efforts. Another new initiative is AIKEYME, a large-scale naval exercise. India served as the first responder for Mauritius during COVID-19. Mauritius participates in India-led VARUNA and MILAN naval drills. Mauritius conferred its highest civilian honour, the Grand Commander of the Order of the Star and Key of the Indian Ocean, on Prime Minister Modi. Mauritius serves as a key gateway for Indian trade and investment. Mauritius is a former British and French colony. Mauritius is a member of the Colombo Security Conclave with Sri Lanka, Maldives and Bangladesh.

Q1.

In which year did the Indian Navy launch MAHASAGAR?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2021
- (D) 2023

Q2.

AIKEYME is a large-scale naval exercise with which group of nations?

- (A) Latin American
- (B) African
- (C) Southeast Asian
- (D) Pacific island

Q3.

IOS Sagar uses which naval platform?

- (A) INS Sunayna
- (B) INS Vikrant
- (C) INS Tabar
- (D) INS Sumitra

Q4.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): MAHASAGAR widens the scope of SAGAR to the broader Global South.

Reason (R): Its focus areas include technology sharing and financial assistance.

Which option is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (C) A is true but R is false.
- (D) A is false but R is true.

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. India's SAGAR maritime doctrine	A. Platform using INS Sunayna
II. MAHASAGAR	B. Maritime doctrine introduced in 2015
III. AIKEYME	C. Widens scope to the broader Global South
IV. IOS Sagar	D. Naval exercise with African nations

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. AIKEYME means 'Unity' in Sanskrit.
- II. MAHASAGAR's focus areas include financial assistance.
- III. The SAGAR maritime doctrine was introduced in 2023.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. MAHASAGAR was launched by the Indian Navy.
- II. MAHASAGAR is limited to India's immediate maritime neighbourhood.
- III. AIKEYME is a naval exercise with Latin American nations.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only one

India-UAE Partnership: Trade and Energy

India and the United Arab Emirates have widened their partnership well beyond trade in goods. During a visit to India by the UAE President, the two governments agreed on a target to expand bilateral commerce over the coming years and promised to create new trade corridors and digital platforms to support it. Energy is another pillar of the relationship, and an agreement between an Emirati gas company and an Indian refiner will supply liquefied natural gas under a supply deal. The two sides also agreed to explore cooperation in advanced nuclear technologies, including small modular reactors and nuclear safety frameworks, a step that follows India's recent law enabling wider international nuclear collaboration. Security ties are growing as well, with a framework for cooperation in defence technology, military training, cyber and emerging security domains. Digital policy is part of the agenda too: a proposal would allow a country to store its most important national data in offshore digital infrastructure, protecting it from cyberattacks, natural disasters and geopolitical disruption. The initiatives deepen economic and strategic ties between the two countries. The agreements cover several sectors at once. Taken together, these steps show that the partnership now covers commerce, energy, nuclear technology, defence and digital infrastructure.

Q1.

By what year did India and the UAE agree to double their bilateral trade to over USD 200 billion?

- (A) 2025
- (B) 2028
- (C) 2032
- (D) 2035

Q2.

In 2022, the UAE signed its Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement first with which country?

- (A) India
- (B) China
- (C) United States
- (D) Saudi Arabia

Q3.

According to the booklet, what share of India's remittance flows did the UAE account for?

- (A) 8%
- (B) 12%
- (C) 15%
- (D) 18%

Q4.

Read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): ADNOC Gas's LNG supply agreement with HPCL is a short-term arrangement.

Reason (R): ADNOC Gas agreed to supply LNG to HPCL for 10 years.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Desert Cyclone	A. Naval
II. Zayed Talwar	B. Abu Dhabi
III. Desert Eagle	C. Military
IV. BAPS Hindu Temple	D. Air Defence Force

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. ADNOC Gas agreed to supply 0.5 million tonnes per annum of LNG to HPCL for 10 years.
- II. Bilateral trade between India and the UAE was US\$ 200 billion in FY 2024-25.
- III. Estonia launched the world's first data embassy in Luxembourg in 2017.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- 1. India has access to the UAE's Al Dhafra Air Base for refuelling.
- 2. Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan is the Prime Minister of the UAE.
- 3. A supercomputing cluster is to be set up under India's AI India Mission as part of the cooperation.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

The UAE and Its Migrant Workers

Its government is led by a Prime Minister, Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, and its leadership also includes a President. The UAE has migrant workers whose employment is regulated by a particular system. Their working lives are governed by an arrangement whose name comes from Arabic, and which is used in several Gulf countries. The arrangement can lead to exploitation and poor working conditions. The UAE's coastline meets the waters of the Gulf, and its maritime frontier is shared with other states. The country also operates a nuclear power plant. In trade, the UAE has signed a comprehensive economic partnership with India, and the two countries have agreed to expand cooperation in defence and nuclear technology. The UAE has also had military personnel in Yemen, where it has been part of the anti-Houthi coalition. The UAE's relations with its neighbours have been tested by recent events in Yemen, where the coalition has faced divisions. The UAE has a traditional Hindu stone temple in its capital city. Remittances from the UAE to India are an important part of the financial links between the two countries.

Q1.

Who is the President of the UAE?

- (A) Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum
- (B) Ali Abdullah Saleh
- (C) Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (D) Rashad al-Alimi

Q2.

Which two countries share land borders with the UAE?

- (A) Oman and Saudi Arabia
- (B) Qatar and Iran
- (C) Iran and Saudi Arabia
- (D) Yemen and Oman

Q3.

Under Kafala, which party typically controls a migrant worker's visa and legal status?

- (A) The worker's family
- (B) The worker's home-country embassy
- (C) The UAE Prime Minister
- (D) The in-country sponsor, typically the employer

Q4.

Read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Kafala can restrict the freedom of movement of migrant workers.

Reason (R): Under Kafala, workers cannot leave the country without the sponsor's permission.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Kafala	A. Currency of the UAE
II. Barakah	B. Capital of the UAE
III. Abu Dhabi	C. Arab world's first nuclear power plant
IV. Dirham	D. Sponsorship in Arabic

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UAE's maritime borders in the Persian Gulf are shared with Qatar and Iran.
- II. The UAE is a federal elective monarchy of seven emirates.
- III. Under Kafala, workers can change jobs without the sponsor's permission.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

1. The UAE's capital is Dubai.
2. Kafala can lead to non-payment of wages for workers.
3. The UAE's currency is the riyal.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Republic Day: History and Origins

Republic Day is celebrated in India on 26 January each year, and its origins lie in the freedom movement. This is the 77th Republic Day, marked in 2026. A session of the Indian National Congress passed a resolution that set out a clear political goal for the country. In the years that followed, Congress asked Indians to observe 26 January as a day of national pride, and the date was marked in this way for many years. The country later gained freedom, which led people to reconsider what the day should mean. The Constitution of India was then adopted by the Constituent Assembly, and it provided a new legal framework for the nation. The date chosen for the Constitution to take effect was 26 January, partly because of its nationalist significance. Because of this link, the day is closely associated with the Constitution. Celebrations begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. Today the main celebrations take place at Kartavya Path, formerly Rajpath, in New Delhi, where a parade is held. The celebrations conclude with the Beating Retreat ceremony at Vijay Chowk, and the day remains a reminder of the journey from colonial rule to a republic.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about Republic Day:

- I. India ceased to be a Dominion of the British Crown and became a Sovereign, Democratic Republic.
- II. Republic Day is celebrated on 15 August each year.
- III. Constitution Day is observed on 26 January each year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Constitution adopted by the Constituent Assembly	A. 15 August 1947
II. Constitution came into effect	B. December 1929
III. India gained independence	C. 26 November 1949
IV. Lahore Session of INC passed the Poorna Swaraj resolution	D. 26 January 1950

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q3.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Congress urged Indians to celebrate 'Independence' on 26 January.
- II. The Constitution was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26 January 1950.
- III. India gained independence on 15 August 1947.

- (A) All of the above
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) Only two

Q4.

Between 1930 and 1947, 26 January was celebrated in India as:

- (A) Constitution Day
- (B) Republic Day
- (C) Independence Day or Poorna Swaraj Day
- (D) Gandhi Jayanti

Q5.

Which demand was made by the resolution passed by the Indian National Congress in December 1929?

- (A) Dominion status within the British Commonwealth
- (B) Total self-rule, sovereignty and complete independence from British rule
- (C) Provincial autonomy under a new Government of India Act
- (D) Transfer of power to a central interim council

Q6.

Which two laws were repealed by the Constitution when it became effective?

- (A) Government of India Act 1935 and the Constitution of India
- (B) Indian Independence Act 1947 and Government of India Act 1935
- (C) Poorna Swaraj resolution and the Declaration of Independence
- (D) Indian Independence Act 1947 and the Declaration of Independence

Flag Unfurling and Hoisting

India observes two national days with the Tricolour, the National Flag, and each has its own ceremony. Republic Day falls on 26 January and marks the day the Constitution came into effect. Independence Day falls on 15 August and marks the nation's freedom from colonial rule. Although the flag is central to both occasions, the way it is handled differs between them. On Republic Day the flag is handled in a way that symbolically renews the nation's commitment to the principles of the Constitution. On Independence Day the flag is raised, a gesture with its own symbolism. The two ceremonies therefore carry different messages while sharing the same symbol. The main Republic Day parade is held at Kartavya Path, formerly known as Rajpath, in New Delhi, and the celebrations conclude with the Beating Retreat ceremony at Vijay Chowk on 29 January. Celebrations begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. The 2026 celebrations carried the theme 150 Years of Vande Mataram, and the parade featured 30 cultural tableaux. Republic Day festivities therefore run from 23 January to 29 January. Together these ceremonies remind citizens of the transition from colonial rule to a republic.

Q1.

Who unfurls the National Flag on Republic Day?

- (A) Prime Minister
- (B) Chief Justice of India
- (C) President of India
- (D) Vice President of India

Q2.

The hoisting of the National Flag on 15 August is said to symbolise:

- (A) Rise of a new nation, patriotism and freedom from colonial rule
- (B) Renewed commitment to the principles of the Constitution
- (C) Unveiling of the flag without pulling it up
- (D) Dominion status under the British Crown

Q3.

Before the National Flag is raised on 15 August, where is it positioned on the pole?

- (A) Folded and attached to the top of the pole
- (B) Halfway up the pole
- (C) Tied across the middle of the pole
- (D) At the bottom of the pole

Q4.

Assertion (A): On Republic Day the Tricolour is unfurled rather than hoisted.

Reason (R): On 26 January the flag is folded or rolled and attached to the top of the pole before it is unveiled.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Republic Day (26 January)	A. Prime Minister
II. Independence Day (15 August)	B. President
III. Head of State	C. Tricolour is unfurled
IV. Head of the Union Government	D. Tricolour is hoisted

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The President unveils the flag on 26 January without pulling it up.
- II. On 15 August the flag is raised from top to bottom.
- III. Unfurling highlights India's shift from a British colony to a Sovereign, Democratic Republic.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The National Flag is hoisted on 26 January.
- II. On 15 August the flag is raised from bottom to top.
- III. The flag is unfurled on 15 August.
- IV. The Prime Minister heads the Union Government.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All four

UGC: Origins and Early Functions

The University Grants Commission, widely known as the UGC, sits at the centre of higher education in India. It is a national body with a clear place in the country's education system. The idea behind such a body was not born in a single moment. It drew on earlier thinking about how universities should be organised and funded. Several reports and committees before it had examined the state of higher education, and their findings formed part of the background. A University Grants Committee was first set up to help manage grants for universities, and its reach was later widened so that it could look after every university in the country. Some years afterwards, a national commission studied university education and proposed a new design for the body. Following that, the government gave the UGC responsibility for overseeing grants for higher education. Today, the Commission is expected to coordinate funding, advise the government on reforms and maintain academic standards across institutions. Over the decades, the body has grown from a small committee into one of the main bodies shaping universities in the country. Its work reaches both universities and colleges, which makes its role in funding and standards especially significant for students across the country.

Q1.

In which year was the UGC formally inaugurated?

- (A) 1945
- (B) 1953
- (C) 1952
- (D) 1956

Q2.

Who chaired the University Education Commission of 1948?

- (A) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (B) Rajendra Prasad
- (C) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (D) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan

Q3.

In which year did the government entrust the UGC with oversight of higher education grants?

- (A) 1952
- (B) 1948
- (C) 1954
- (D) 1958

Q4.

Assertion (A): The UGC is a statutory body.

Reason (R): It was set up under the UGC Act, 1956.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (C) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Sargeant Report	A. 1948
II. University Grants Committee set up	B. 1947
III. Committee expanded to oversee all Indian universities	C. 1945
IV. University Education Commission	D. 1944

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Read the statements about the UGC:

I. Its headquarters is in New Delhi.

II. It was formally inaugurated in 1945.

III. It allocates grants to universities and colleges.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the statements below about the UGC:

I. Maulana Abul Kalam Azad formally inaugurated the UGC.

II. Its headquarters is in Mumbai.

III. The Sargeant Report is the source of the idea behind the UGC.

How many of the statements above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Concerns About the Equity Rules

The UGC's 2026 equity regulations have not been welcomed by everyone. The regulations were notified as part of a wider effort to promote equity, inclusion and anti-discrimination in higher education institutions. Some observers argue that the framework, however well intended, needs closer study before it is applied on campuses. Their concerns cover several areas. They examine how complaints are received and looked into, the protection available to people who are named in them, and the length of time given for a fact-finding exercise. They also ask how a rule meant to protect students and staff might work in everyday campus life. A further line of criticism concerns

the wider effect of the rules on the campus community as a whole. The Supreme Court has also taken note of the regulations, and its decision to pause them has added to the public discussion. Supporters, meanwhile, see the regulations as a step toward fairness and inclusion. The debate reflects a broader question in Indian public life about how to tackle discrimination without creating new anxieties for those who learn and work in universities. Observers from different backgrounds have offered views on how the regulations could be improved in practice, and those views are part of the wider discussion. This is why the regulations continue to be discussed in academic and public forums.

Q1.

Students and faculty could fear which kind of consequences under the framework?

- (A) Transfer to another campus
- (B) Loss of UGC recognition
- (C) Criminal consequences
- (D) Higher tuition fees

Q2.

What might the framework indirectly influence, according to critics?

- (A) The social and demographic composition of campuses
- (B) The fee structure of universities
- (C) The election of the UGC Chairman
- (D) The number of Equal Opportunity Centres

Q3.

Which of the following is NOT among the concerns raised about the regulations?

- (A) Compressed inquiry timelines
- (B) Absence of explicit protection against false complaints
- (C) Automatic linkage of the helpline to police
- (D) Excessive fees charged to complainants

Q4.

Assertion (A): Students and faculty may hesitate to approach the helpline.

Reason (R): The helpline is automatically linked to police authorities.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true and R correctly explains A
- (C) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. No confidentiality for the accused	A. Discouraging open academic discourse
II. No explicit safeguards against false complaints	B. Risk of reputational damage
III. Compressed inquiry timelines	C. Concern about misuse of complaints
IV. Helpline's automatic linkage to police	D. Risk of errors in decision-making

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Read the statements about the regulations:

- I. Critics say the framework offers no explicit protection against false complaints.
- II. Critics say the regulations provide confidentiality for the accused.
- III. Critics say short inquiry periods may increase the risk of errors.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the statements below about the concerns:

- I. Critics fear the framework could influence the social and demographic composition of campuses.
- II. The regulations provide confidentiality for the accused.
- III. Students and faculty could fear criminal consequences.

How many of the statements above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Launch, Aim and Management: MCQ practice

The Startup India Initiative is covered in the Polity and Governance section of the 2026 current affairs material. The topic came into the news because India marked a milestone anniversary of the programme. The booklet links this milestone with National Startup Day, which it describes as a day for celebrating entrepreneurial growth. The programme is run by a government department, and that department works within a larger ministry. The booklet also presents a table titled Terms Related to Startup Valuations. This table places labels against valuation levels, so that companies at different stages can be described using a common vocabulary. Each label is linked to a figure in dollars, and the labels appear in a fixed order in the table. The booklet treats the programme's institutional set-up and its valuation vocabulary as two separate areas of the subject. Both areas are part of its wider discussion of the initiative and of current affairs coverage in governance. Taken together, the material gives a basic picture of how the initiative is run and how startup growth is described. The same section of the booklet lists several schemes that operate under the initiative, each with its own purpose. Those schemes are presented as flagship schemes, and they cover areas such as seed funding and credit guarantees.

Q1.

Which of the following is the stated aim of the Startup India Initiative?

- (A) Regulating foreign investment in listed companies
- (B) Building rural road networks across states
- (C) Fostering startup culture and building an inclusive ecosystem for innovation and entrepreneurship
- (D) Setting national school curricula for entrepreneurship

Q2.

Which term describes a startup with the potential to reach a valuation of 1 billion dollars in the near future?

- (A) Decacorn
- (B) Soonicorn
- (C) Hectocorn
- (D) Atal Incubation Centre

Q3.

What valuation does a hectocorn represent?

- (A) 1 billion dollars
- (B) 100 billion dollars
- (C) 10 billion dollars
- (D) 1,000 billion dollars

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Startup India Initiative was launched in 2014.

Reason (R): The initiative is managed by DPIIT, which operates under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A decacorn is a startup valued at 10 billion dollars.
- II. A soonicorn is a startup already valued at 10 billion dollars.
- III. The Startup India Initiative was launched on 16 January.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Startup India Initiative is managed by the Ministry of Finance.
- II. The Startup India Initiative is managed by DPIIT.
- III. A soonicorn is a startup valued at 100 billion dollars.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

What is the full name of DPIIT, the body that manages the Startup India Initiative?

- (A) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (B) Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion
- (C) Department for Promotion of Information Technology
- (D) Department of Investment and Internal Trade

Eligibility and Core Features: MCQ practice

The core features of the Startup India Initiative are set out in a list in the booklet, with several headings under which the initiative's provisions are grouped. The headings cover who qualifies, how the initiative eases the business process, what tax benefits are available, and what kind of funding support is offered. Eligibility is described in terms of the entity's location, its age and its size, which are measured in different ways. The booklet presents these conditions as a short checklist, so that a reader can compare the criteria side by side. Ease of doing business is listed under a heading of its own, covering several measures that the booklet says streamline processes for startups. The measures are presented as part of the initiative's core features, not as a separate scheme. Tax benefits form a separate heading, and the booklet presents them as applying to startups that meet the eligibility conditions. Funding support is listed under its own heading, which

includes the Fund of Funds for Startups. Sector-specific policies appear as a further heading, and the booklet describes them as focused policies for particular fields. Taken together, the headings give a structured overview of the initiative's features, although the booklet presents each heading separately. Each heading is written as a short bulleted point in the booklet, so the details stay concise.

Q1.

Which mechanism is used to streamline clearances for startups under the initiative?

- (A) Annual self-audit by the state government
- (B) Single-window clearances
- (C) Joint venture licensing
- (D) Triple-tier arbitration

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maximum years since the startup opened	A. Less than 100 crore
II. Annual turnover ceiling	B. Biotechnology, agriculture and renewable energy
III. Tax exemption period	C. Opened less than 10 years ago
IV. Sector-specific policies	D. 3 consecutive financial years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q3.

Which of the following is listed among the ease of doing business measures for startups?

- (A) Simplified compliance
- (B) Mandatory physical inspection before every registration
- (C) Compulsory listing on a stock exchange
- (D) Fixed annual licence fees for every startup

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Startups receive self-certification under the initiative's ease of doing business measures.
- II. Eligible startups enjoy tax exemptions for 5 consecutive financial years.
- III. Biotechnology is one of the sectors covered by sector-specific policies.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Assertion (A): A startup headquartered outside India can qualify under the initiative.

Reason (R): A startup must be an entity headquartered in India to qualify.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A startup must be headquartered in India to qualify.
- II. Opening less than 10 years ago is one of the conditions for a startup to qualify.
- III. Annual turnover of 100 crore or more is one of the conditions for a startup to qualify.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

The Fund of Funds for Startups supports which stage of funding?

- (A) Late-stage funding
- (B) Pre-IPO funding
- (C) Debt restructuring
- (D) Early-stage funding

Mentorship, Networking and Events: MCQ practice

The Startup India Initiative's wider support system includes platforms that link startups with mentors and investors, along with a flagship event that brings the ecosystem together. One platform is described in the booklet as connecting startups, investors and mentors, and it is treated as a recent addition to the initiative. A second platform is listed alongside it, and it is described through the functions it performs for the startups it serves. The flagship event is described as bringing together a wide group of participants, including startups at different stages, investors, industry leaders and ecosystem stakeholders. The booklet also states that the event has an edition scheduled to take place, with details of its timing and location included in the same section. Readers will find the platforms and the event described briefly, each with a single line of explanation in the booklet. The section therefore brings together three themes: the connections made through platforms, the networks formed through events and the mentors who support new businesses. Each of these items is kept separate in the booklet, so that a reader can tell the platforms apart from the event.

Q1.

Which group of cities does the BHASKAR Platform aim to empower?

- (A) Metro cities
- (B) Port cities
- (C) Non-metro cities
- (D) Border towns

Q2.

Which of the following is the function of MAARG?

- (A) Intelligent matchmaking between mentors and startups
- (B) Issuing startup registration certificates
- (C) Managing the national startup budget
- (D) Organising annual trade fairs

Q3.

Assertion (A): The BHASKAR Platform was launched in 2023.

Reason (R): The BHASKAR Platform connects startups, investors and mentors.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

What does BHASKAR stand for?

- (A) Bharat Startup Knowledge and Research
- (B) Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry
- (C) Bharat Support for Knowledge and Research
- (D) Bharat System for Knowledge Access and Registry

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BHASKAR Platform was launched in 2024.
- II. MAARG stands for Mentorship, Advisory, Assistance, Research and Growth.
- III. The 5th Startup Mahakumbh is scheduled in March in New Delhi.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. BHASKAR aims to empower non-metro cities.
- II. The BHASKAR Platform was launched in 2022.
- III. Startup Mahakumbh brings together startups, investors and industry leaders.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which flagship event brings together startups, unicorns, soonicorns, investors and industry leaders?

- (A) Startup Mahakumbh
- (B) Atal Incubation Centre
- (C) BHASKAR Platform
- (D) MAARG

Farm Safeguards and CBAM

Agriculture is a sensitive area in the India-EU agreement. Under the agreement, duties on over 90% of bilateral trade have been removed, while sensitive items are handled separately. To protect rural livelihoods and domestic food security, both India and the European Union have maintained comprehensive negative lists for sensitive commodities. Products on these lists remain outside the tariff reduction framework, and the lists are meant to shield small-scale farmers from import surges.

Protection also extends to names and origins. A parallel agreement reinforces legal protection for geographical indications, preventing unauthorised use or imitation of iconic products in either market. Such a parallel agreement sits alongside the main trade terms.

Environmental rules form another strand. The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism is an EU policy that imposes a carbon price on imports of selected goods from countries with less stringent climate regulations. India has viewed this measure as a possible form of green protectionism that could undermine export competitiveness. To support the transition, the European Union has promised financial and technical help for Indian industries seeking decarbonisation, and a Technical Cooperation Group will help exporters verify carbon footprints.

The agreement's safeguards therefore cover both agriculture and the environment. Together, these safeguards show how the agreement pairs market opening with protection for vulnerable sectors.

Q1.

Which of the following items is excluded from India's tariff reduction framework?

- (A) Beef
- (B) Sugar
- (C) Poultry
- (D) Cotton

Q2.

Which of the following is excluded from the European Union's tariff reduction framework?

- (A) Beef
- (B) Dairy
- (C) Wheat
- (D) Cotton

Q3.

Which of the following is NOT among the sectors covered by the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism?

- (A) Fertilisers
- (B) Hydrogen
- (C) Electricity
- (D) Textiles and apparel

Q4.

Assertion (A): Importers under the CBAM must buy certificates that correspond to the embedded carbon emissions in their goods.

Reason (R): The price of these certificates is linked to the carbon price of the EU Emissions Trading System.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Transitional phase (2023-2025)	A. Excluded from the EU's tariff reduction framework
II. Dairy	B. Allowed if the carbon tax was paid in the exporting country
III. Credit for a carbon tax already paid	C. Excluded from India's tariff reduction framework
IV. Sugar	D. Mandatory emissions reporting with no financial levy

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India received a most-favoured-nation assurance under CBAM.
- II. India received a full exemption from CBAM.
- III. Wheat is excluded from India's tariff reduction framework.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Iron and steel is a sector covered by CBAM.
- II. Rice is excluded from India's tariff reduction framework.
- III. Beef is excluded from India's tariff reduction framework.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Towards 2030 Agenda Pillars

India and the European Union have taken their ties beyond trade. Their joint strategic agenda aims to move the relationship from a mainly trade-oriented engagement into a multi-dimensional strategic partnership. It is meant to act as a structured action roadmap for a period marked by geopolitical uncertainty, economic fragmentation and rising protectionism.

The agenda is arranged into several pillars. The economic pillar centres on implementing the free trade agreement, while technology cooperation covers emerging areas and resilient supply chains. Defence cooperation is being reshaped, moving away from a simple buyer-seller relationship. Connectivity projects also feature in the plan. Cyber cooperation includes a partnership between the CBI and Europol. The EU's Global Gateway initiative is among the infrastructure efforts linked to the agenda.

The wider context matters. India is actively reducing its reliance on the US market, and the European market is presented as a stable, rules-based alternative. The agreement is described as reducing dependence on a single market. Space and cyber cooperation is also under way, including collaboration between ISRO and the European Space Agency. Joint research on advanced technologies is another area.

Cooperation on green transition and decarbonisation is also part of the agenda. The agenda builds on ties that have been developing for many years.

Q1.

Under which pillar of the 'Towards 2030' agenda does maritime security in the Indo-Pacific fall?

- (A) Prosperity and Sustainability
- (B) Technology and Innovation
- (C) Connectivity and Global Challenges
- (D) Security and Defence

Q2.

Under which pillar does the European Legal Gateway in India fall?

- (A) Enablers: Skills and Mobility
- (B) Connectivity and Global Challenges
- (C) Technology and Innovation
- (D) Security and Defence

Q3.

Which pillar includes plans for 6G, semiconductors and quantum computing?

- (A) Prosperity and Sustainability
- (B) Security and Defence
- (C) Technology and Innovation
- (D) Enablers: Skills and Mobility

Q4.

Assertion (A): The 'Towards 2030' agenda is a five-year strategic framework.

Reason (R): It was adopted at the 16th India-EU Summit.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Green Hydrogen Task Force	A. Connectivity and Global Challenges pillar
II. Exploratory talks on Horizon Europe	B. Prosperity and Sustainability pillar
III. IMEC acceleration	C. Security and Defence pillar
IV. Joint R&D on drones and sensor systems	D. Technology and Innovation pillar

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. Mutual recognition of professional qualifications is targeted by 2030.

II. The Security and Defence pillar focuses on the Arctic region.

III. The Technology and Innovation pillar includes the Trade and Technology Council.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. IMEC is part of the Connectivity pillar.
- II. The agenda was adopted at the 15th India-EU Summit.
- III. The Enablers pillar covers skills and mobility.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

EU Institutions and Ties

The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 member states, with a set of shared institutions. Its roots lie in a cooperation arrangement among a small group of countries, and it has since grown into one of the world's largest economic blocs. Its climate ambition is to cut net greenhouse emissions by 55 per cent by 2030, compared with 1990 levels. Services make up most of the union's economic output. The union's single market is one of its defining features. Adoption of EU regulations, sometimes called the Brussels Effect, shapes standards for partners beyond Europe. Standards set by the union can influence exporters in other markets. Summits between the two sides began in 2000.

Several bodies share responsibilities within the union. Each has a distinct role in the union's work. The union also has a court that deals with questions about EU law.

Member states differ widely in population and geography, and the union's membership has changed over time. The United Kingdom's departure reduced the number of members, although the union remains an important partner for India.

India and the EU have maintained diplomatic relations for a long time, and their ties have grown into a strategic partnership supported by trade, investment and institutional dialogue.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to the EU in 2012.
- II. Malta is the EU's largest member by population.
- III. The European Council is made up of heads of state or government.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. European Council	A. Co-legislates and approves the budget
II. Court of Justice of the EU	B. Manages the euro and monetary policy for the eurozone
III. European Central Bank	C. Sets the overall political direction of the EU
IV. European Parliament	D. Ensures uniform application of EU law

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q3.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Members of the European Parliament are elected every five years.
 - II. Ireland is part of the Schengen Area.
 - III. All EU members except Cyprus and Ireland are in the Schengen Area.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q4.

Assertion (A): The euro was launched in 1999.

Reason (R): The euro is the currency of the euro area, which is formed by the member states that use it.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Which EU member state is the largest by area?

- (A) France
- (B) Germany
- (C) Italy
- (D) Spain

Q6.

Which EU institution proposes laws, enforces rules and manages the budget?

- (A) European Council
- (B) European Commission
- (C) European Parliament
- (D) European Central Bank

Q7.

In which year did the United Kingdom withdraw from the EU (Brexit)?

- (A) 2016
- (B) 2018
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2020

Demographic Winter: Indicators and Key Terms

China's population fell by 3.39 million in 2025, bringing the total to 1.405 billion. It was the fourth consecutive year of decline, and births dropped to 7.92 million over the same period. These figures sit within a wider pattern that the booklet calls demographic winter. The booklet notes that this pattern is no longer confined to developed countries and is now a global phenomenon. Its effects are described as reaching several areas of national life, including economic growth, public finances and the provision of care. Ageing populations are said to bring a rising fiscal burden on governments. The booklet presents a set of key indicators that help identify this phase, and it discusses the causes and negative impacts of the pattern in separate sections. This material is part of the January 2026 issue of current affairs, which covers reports, summits and indices. The chapter also includes practice questions on the main figures and terms. The topic is placed under the heading China's Population Declines for Fourth Consecutive Year, which marks the main subject of the issue. The booklet describes the phase in simple terms and links the 2025 figures to the wider trend. Readers will also find definitions of key terms at the end of the section.

Q1.

What replacement level of fertility, in children per woman, does the booklet give for population stability?

- (A) 1.9
- (B) 2.1
- (C) 2.5
- (D) 3.0

Q2.

Which population pattern is described as a key indicator of demographic winter?

- (A) A broad young base with a small elderly population
- (B) A pyramid in which the elderly population is shrinking
- (C) An inverted population pyramid with a shrinking young population and an expanding elderly population
- (D) An equal share of all age groups across the population

Q3.

Which of the following is listed among the negative impacts of a declining population?

- (A) Shrinking workforce threatening future labour supply
- (B) Greater reproductive autonomy for women
- (C) Reduced pressure on pension systems
- (D) Lower burden on healthcare services

Q4.

Assertion (A): Demographic winter is a temporary dip that usually reverses once fertility falls below replacement level.

Reason (R): Developed nation trends show that a rebound is unlikely once rates fall below replacement level.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Demographic winter	A. Children born to a woman during reproductive years (ages 15-49)
II. Total fertility rate	B. Growth potential from a larger working-age population compared to dependents
III. Demographic dividend	C. Average births per woman
IV. Fertility	D. A persistent and structural decline in population growth

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q6.

- I. Access to family planning is listed among the causes of demographic winter.
- II. Low-fertility states face youth shortages, while high-fertility states struggle with overpopulation.
- III. A rebound in fertility is likely once rates fall below the replacement level.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about demographic winter are correct?

The demographic dividend describes growth potential from a larger working-age population compared to dependents.

Declining fertility and late marriages are linked to social isolation and mental health challenges.

An inverted population pyramid shows a growing young population and a shrinking elderly population.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Causes and Impacts of Demographic Winter

A decline in population growth is not explained by one factor alone. The booklet describes it as the result of several forces, and it separates these forces into causes and negative impacts. The causes relate to choices that people make about their careers, their homes and their families, along with the social setting in which those choices are made. Some causes are economic in nature, while others reflect changing attitudes towards family life. The booklet then turns to the consequences of the pattern, which it presents as pressures on several parts of society. These pressures reach the economy, the health sector and the care of people in later life. The booklet also links the pattern to the social and emotional well-being of families. Causes and impacts are set out in the same chapter, so readers can see the reasons behind the decline alongside its effects. Each cause and each impact is presented as a separate point, with its own short explanation in the text. The chapter also includes practice questions on the main figures and terms. The chapter is titled Reports, Summits, Indices and forms part of the January 2026 issue. The booklet uses the term demographic winter

for the wider phase in which these causes and impacts appear.

Q1.

Which of the following is cited as a reason for later marriages and parenthood?

- (A) Lower housing and education costs
- (B) Greater economic security
- (C) Fewer women in the workforce
- (D) High housing and education costs

Q2.

According to the booklet, what does access to family planning provide?

- (A) Greater reproductive autonomy
- (B) Higher numbers of unintended births
- (C) Larger preferred family sizes
- (D) Reduced participation of women in work

Q3.

Which negative impact is linked to smaller families disrupting traditional support systems?

- (A) Rising birth rates among the young
- (B) Faster growth of the workforce
- (C) Greater isolation of the elderly
- (D) Lower dependence on family care

Q4.

Assertion (A): Low-fertility states can face shortages of young people.

Reason (R): High-fertility states struggle with overpopulation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Delayed life milestones	A. Reduces unintended births
II. Urbanisation	B. Greater female workforce participation
III. Access to family planning	C. Smaller and costlier urban housing
IV. Societal shifts	D. Later marriages and parenthood due to career priorities

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

I. Shrinking workforce threatens future labour supply as youth replacement falls short over time.

II. Developed nation trends show that a rebound is likely once fertility falls below the replacement level.

III. Smaller families disrupt traditional support systems, leading to greater isolation of the elderly.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the impacts of a declining population are correct?

Ageing population growth poses a rising burden on healthcare, elderly care and pension systems.

Declining fertility and late marriages are linked to social isolation and mental health challenges.

Access to family planning increases the number of unintended births.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Reasons Behind China's Population Decline

China's population has been falling for several years, and the booklet explains this through a set of connected reasons. It first points to a sharp fall in the average number of children per woman, which it describes as far below the level needed to keep a population stable. Earlier government policy forms part of the story, since birth limits were in place for a long period. The booklet also notes that the birth rate did not recover after those limits were loosened, and it treats this as evidence of deeper changes. Social and economic conditions are described as strong influences, including work pressures and the cost of living. The booklet adds that a major public health event and the economic uncertainty that followed it sped up the decline. It also says that the pressures are felt most by younger generations. Taken together, the reasons range from changes in women's lives to the effects of a global health crisis. The booklet also states that these later events accelerated the decline rather than starting it. The phrase used for the broader phase in this chapter is demographic winter, which is discussed in the earlier pages. This section of the January 2026 issue sits within the chapter titled Reports, Summits, Indices.

Q1.

Which policy is credited with reducing China's total fertility rate from 2.75 in 1979?

- (A) One-Child Policy
- (B) Two-Child Policy
- (C) Three-Child Policy
- (D) Great Leap Forward

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Female education and employment	A. Reduced societal pressure to marry early or have multiple children
II. COVID-19 pandemic	B. Discourages marriage and childbearing among younger generations
III. Intense job competition	C. Enhanced women's autonomy over reproductive decisions
IV. Changing family norms	D. Accelerated the population decline

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q3.

- I. Higher female education and employment have enhanced women's autonomy over reproductive decisions.
- II. Fertility rates rebounded after the Three-Child Policy was introduced in 2021.
- III. Growing disengagement from traditional family structures has increased pressure to marry early.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I and III only

Q4.

Which year marks the official end of the One-Child Policy?

- (A) 2014
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2021
- (D) 2016

Q5.

How many of the following statements about China's population decline are correct?

The One-Child Policy was introduced in 1980 to curb rapid population growth.

Housing pressures and economic uncertainty discourage fertility, especially among younger generations.

Fertility rates have rebounded after each relaxation of China's birth limits.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which factor is said to have reduced societal pressure to marry early or have multiple children?

- (A) Stronger traditional family structures
- (B) Rising housing costs
- (C) Growing disengagement from traditional family structures
- (D) Early marriage customs

Fisheries Sector in India: MCQ Practice

India's fisheries sector is part of the agriculture and allied sectors, and it makes a notable contribution to agricultural output. The sector covers both capture fisheries and aquaculture, and India also exports seafood to buyers abroad. The government has launched several schemes to strengthen the sector. The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana was introduced as part of the Atma Nirbhar Bharat Package, with the aim of bringing a Blue Revolution through the sustainable and responsible development of fisheries. Its focus areas include modernising fisheries infrastructure, promoting sustainable aquaculture practices, improving post-harvest management, and enhancing the livelihoods of fishers and fish farmers. A sub-scheme under it, the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana, supports micro and small enterprises operating in the sector and aims to formalise the sector under a national digital platform. The sector is also supported by integrated aqua parks, with parks planned in several states, and by a plan to develop climate resilient coastal fishermen villages. The scheme also aims to enhance fish production and productivity in India, to double farmers' income, and to coordinate fishery development in an integrated and holistic manner. A Fisheries Infrastructure Development Fund also envisages the creation of fisheries infrastructure in both marine and inland fisheries.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Total fish output (2024-25)	A. 2023-24 to 2026-27
II. First riverine dolphin estimation	B. Rs 6,000 crore
III. Investment of PM Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana	C. 6,327 dolphins
IV. Implementation period of Sah-Yojana	D. 197.75 lakh tonnes

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q2.

According to the booklet, what percentage of agriculture Gross Value Added does the fisheries sector contribute?

- (A) 5.43%
- (B) 7.43%
- (C) 9.43%
- (D) 11.43%

Q3.

In which year was the National Fisheries Development Board established?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 2002
- (C) 2011
- (D) 2016

Q4.

How many of the following statements about India's fisheries sector are correct?

- I. The Matsya Setu App was launched by the NFDB and ICAR's Central Institute of Freshwater Aquaculture, Bhubaneswar.
 - II. Half of the Sah-Yojana investment comes from public finance, including the World Bank and the Agence Francaise de Developpement.
 - III. The Sagarmala Programme focuses on port-led development.
 - IV. The Sagarmala Programme focuses on fisheries education.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements about India's fisheries sector:

- I. The National Fisheries Development Board works under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying.
- II. Fisheries is a State subject in India.
- III. National Fish Farmers Day is observed on 21 November.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Which country is the largest importer of Indian seafood?

- (A) China
- (B) Japan
- (C) Vietnam
- (D) United States

WTO Fisheries Subsidies: MCQ Practice

The UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, also called the constitution for the oceans, sets out the legal framework within which all activities in the oceans and seas must be carried out. The UN High Seas Treaty, or BBNJ Agreement, is a legally binding international treaty governing ocean spaces beyond national jurisdiction. The high seas and the international seabed area are considered global commons, open to all states for activities such as navigation, overflight and laying of submarine cables and pipelines. The 1994 Agreement on Part XI deals with deep seabed mining, and the 1995 UN Fish Stocks Agreement is another implementing agreement under the Convention. The WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies was adopted at the 12th Ministerial Conference in 2022. Its objective is to establish binding rules that curb harmful fisheries subsidies. The agreement entered into force in September 2025, after two-thirds of members had approved it. It supports Sustainable Development Goal 14, which aims to conserve and sustainably use oceans, seas and marine resources. The WTO Fish Fund provides aid to developing and least developed country members for implementing the agreement. The International Seabed Authority has the mandate to ensure the effective protection of the marine environment from harmful effects that may arise from deep-seabed related activities.

Q1.

Under the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies, subsidies for fishing on which type of stocks are prohibited?

- (A) Farmed stocks
- (B) Overfished stocks
- (C) Coastal stocks
- (D) Freshwater stocks

Q2.

Under the agreement, subsidies linked to which kind of fishing are prohibited?

- (A) Recreational fishing
- (B) Subsistence fishing
- (C) Inland aquaculture
- (D) Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) fishing

Q3.

Under the agreement, support for fishing in which area is prohibited?

- (A) Unregulated high seas
- (B) Coastal lagoons
- (C) Inland rivers
- (D) Regulated fishing grounds

Q4.

Assertion (A): India has not joined the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies.

Reason (R): India has cited the need to protect small fishers, livelihoods and food security.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Obligation placed on members	A. Did not join
II. Support for fishing on overfished stocks	B. Flexibility within common rules
III. India's position on the agreement	C. Submit fisheries-related data
IV. Treatment of developing countries	D. Prohibited

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies:

- I. Subsidies for fishing on overfished stocks are prohibited.
- II. Developing countries receive no flexibility under the agreement.
- III. Members must submit fisheries-related data.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies are correct?

- I. Subsidies linked to IUU fishing are prohibited.
- II. India has joined the agreement.
- III. Support for fishing in unregulated high seas is permitted.
- IV. Members must submit fisheries-related data.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

PSLV-C62 payloads: MCQ practice

The PSLV-C62 flight carried a main satellite along with several other payloads. A second payload, KID, was a vehicle built by a firm from abroad, and its job was to test how a small craft comes back through the atmosphere. Another payload, AayulSAT, came from a company based in Bengaluru and was among the technology demonstrations on the launch. Commercial customers from several countries also sent their satellites on the same flight, which made the list of passengers a long one. The rocket was set to lift off from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh. The mission followed an earlier setback in the same programme and was ISRO's first launch of the year 2026. The PSLV is a four-stage vehicle that was first launched in 1993 and uses solid propellants in its first and third stages and liquid propellants in its second and fourth stages. Its notable missions include Chandrayaan-1, the Mars Orbiter Mission and AstroSat. ISRO was formerly known as INCOSPAR and was renamed in 1969, and it is headquartered in Bengaluru. The Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System, known as NavIC, is another ISRO programme.

Q1.

What is the stated purpose of EOS-N1 (Anvesha)?

- (A) Lunar surface mapping
- (B) Deep-space communication relay
- (C) Strengthen space-based Earth observation and monitoring
- (D) Crewed orbital flights

Q2.

Which of these countries is among those whose commercial payloads flew on PSLV-C62?

- (A) Mauritius
- (B) Japan
- (C) Canada
- (D) Russia

Q3.

What does the acronym KID stand for?

- (A) Kinetic Initial Demonstrator
- (B) Kerbal Initial Demonstrator
- (C) Kinetic Impact Device
- (D) Kestrel Initial Demonstrator

Q4.

Assertion (A): EOS-N1 was intended for a sun-synchronous orbit.

Reason (R): KID was developed by a Spanish startup.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. EOS-N1 (Anvesha)	A. Spanish startup
II. AayulSAT	B. Re-entry and splashdown in the South Pacific Ocean
III. KID developer	C. India's 1st on-orbit satellite refuelling payload
IV. KID mission	D. Hyperspectral imaging satellite

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

I. EOS-N1 (Anvesha) is a hyperspectral imaging satellite.

II. KID is a small-scale re-entry vehicle prototype.

III. AayulSAT was developed by a Spanish startup.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

- I. AayulSAT is India's first on-orbit satellite refuelling payload.
- II. KID's mission involved splashdown in the South Pacific Ocean.
- III. EOS-N1 was developed by ISRO.
- IV. AayulSAT is India's first weather satellite.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Launch vehicles and private players: MCQ practice

India's launch vehicles come in several families, and each has its own role. Early rockets in the line came first, and newer designs followed. The Next Generation Launch Vehicle is a planned rocket, still in development, that is meant to carry much larger payloads than the current options. The NGLV is designed to be reusable and green. It is expected to enable missions such as human spaceflight. Another rocket, the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle, has flown test missions and is launched from Sriharikota. The SSLV is a three-stage vehicle, and its producing body is NSIL. Private companies have also started building rockets of their own. Agnikul Cosmos is one such company, and its rockets are launched from a privately developed launchpad. Its founders include Srinath Ravichandran, Moin SPM and Satya Chakravarthy, and its rocket is described as the world's first with a fully 3D-printed engine. The Indian Space Policy is the government's plan to let private enterprises take part in space activity. The Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre, based in Ahmedabad, helps private players take part in space activity. ISRO, India's national space agency, is headquartered in Bengaluru. The Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle, GSLV, has a Mk-III version that made ISRO entirely self-sufficient.

Q1.

Which launch vehicle is suited to launching multiple microsatellites and takes that load off the PSLV?

- (A) SLV
- (B) GSLV
- (C) SSLV
- (D) NGLV

Q2.

What is the maximum payload capability of the NGLV?

- (A) 10 tonnes
- (B) 30 tonnes
- (C) 3 tonnes
- (D) 300 tonnes

Q3.

What does SOrTeD, a demonstrator developed by Agnikul Cosmos, stand for?

- (A) Satellite Orbital Technology Demonstrator
- (B) Sub Orbital Trial Device
- (C) Sub Orbital Thrust Demonstrator
- (D) SubOrbital Technology Demonstrator

Q4.

Assertion (A): SSLV-D2 was a successful test flight.

Reason (R): SSLV-D1 ended in failure in 2022.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. SLV	A. India's first reusable hybrid rocket
II. GSLV	B. ISRO's first satellite launch vehicle
III. SSLV	C. Carries heavier satellites deeper into space
IV. RHUMI-1	D. Suited to launching multiple microsattellites

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

I. SLV was ISRO's first satellite launch vehicle, followed by ASLV.

II. NGLV has a maximum payload capability of 50 tonnes.

III. SSLV-D1 was a success in 2022.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

I. RHUMI-1 was developed by Space Zone India.

II. SOrTeD is a two-stage rocket.

III. Agnikul Cosmos was founded in 2010.

IV. The NGLV costs about three times as much as LVM3.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

Rules 2026 and Sports Bodies

The National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026 are meant to enhance transparency, inclusivity and accountability in sports administration in India. The Rules apply to national sports bodies, which include the national committees that oversee Olympic and Paralympic sports as well as the federations that govern particular sports at the national level. Under the Rules, every national sports body must have a General Body and an Executive Committee. The General Body must include sportspersons of outstanding merit, and a specified share of those sportspersons must be women. The Executive Committee must also include women members. The Rules set conditions that govern who may hold office in these bodies, and they limit how long a person can serve, using both a number of years and an upper age limit. Members therefore serve

for a fixed period and must continue to meet the conditions laid down in the Rules. Taken together, the provisions are intended to make the governance of national sports bodies more transparent and accountable. The framework also includes a National Sports Board, which is described as the apex regulatory body for sports governance in India. The framework itself forms part of the National Sports Governance Act, whose key institutional mechanisms came into force from January 2026.

Q1.

What share of the sportspersons of outstanding merit in the General Body must be women?

- (A) 25%
- (B) 33%
- (C) 50%
- (D) 75%

Q2.

Which authority notified the National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026?

- (A) Supreme Court
- (B) Election Commission
- (C) Sports Authority of India
- (D) Union Government

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Paralympic Committee	A. 3 years or up to 65 years of age, whichever is earlier
II. Term of members	B. At least 4 women members
III. Executive Committee	C. Minimum age of 25 years
IV. Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit	D. Sole governing body for Paralympic sports

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements about national sports bodies under the Rules:

- I. Regional sports federations are among the other bodies governed under the Rules.
- II. A person who has been convicted by a court and sentenced to imprisonment is disqualified from holding office.
- III. The National Olympic Committee is the sole governing body for Paralympic sports.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q5.

Which body is the sole governing body for Olympic sports in India?

- (A) National Sports Federation
- (B) National Olympic Committee
- (C) Regional Sports Federation
- (D) National Sports Board

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Members serve for 3 years or up to 65 years of age, whichever is earlier.
 - II. The National Paralympic Committee is the sole governing body for Olympic sports in India.
 - III. Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit in the General Body must be at least 25 years of age.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

National Sports Tribunal

The National Sports Tribunal was set up to resolve disputes in sport. Its stated purpose is to provide a forum that is independent and speedy. The Tribunal's functioning is linked to the wider framework of the National Sports Governance Act, which introduced several institutional mechanisms for sports administration in India. The Tribunal does not hear every type of dispute, because its jurisdiction is defined by the framework and certain categories of matters are kept outside it. Some matters that relate to sport are handled under separate laws and procedures, and the Tribunal's role must be understood in that context. The Tribunal has a defined structure, with a head and other members who bring relevant knowledge to its work. Its purpose, scope and structure together show how the framework seeks to bring clarity and order to the settlement of sports disputes in the country. The key institutional mechanisms of the Act came into force from January 2026. The Rules and mechanisms under the Act aim to enhance transparency, inclusivity and accountability in sports administration. The Tribunal is therefore one of several bodies created to strengthen sports administration in India. Its work is part of that framework and is expected to be read alongside the Rules that apply to national sports bodies.

Q1.

Along with being independent and speedy, which two adjectives describe the Tribunal's intended resolution of sports disputes?

- (A) Effective and cost-efficient
- (B) Lengthy and formal
- (C) Partisan and costly
- (D) Optional and informal

Q2.

Under which Act do doping-related disputes fall exclusively?

- (A) National Sports Governance Act
- (B) WADA Compliance Act
- (C) National Anti-Doping Act 2022
- (D) Sports Authority of India Act

Q3.

Which of these is NOT among the fields from which the Tribunal's two other members are drawn?

- (A) Medicine
- (B) Sports
- (C) Public administration
- (D) Law

Q4.

Assertion (A): The National Sports Tribunal can hear disputes arising during the Olympic Games.

Reason (R): Disputes arising during major international sporting events such as the Olympic Games are excluded from the Tribunal's jurisdiction.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Election disputes	A. Excluded from the Tribunal's jurisdiction
II. Doping-related disputes	B. Sitting or retired Supreme Court judge or Chief Justice of a High Court
III. Disputes during the Asian Games	C. Within the Tribunal's jurisdiction
IV. Head of the Tribunal	D. Governed by the National Anti-Doping Act 2022

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the National Sports Tribunal:

- I. Governance matters fall within the jurisdiction of the Tribunal.
- II. Disputes arising during the Commonwealth Games are within the Tribunal's jurisdiction.
- III. Athlete selection issues fall within the Tribunal's jurisdiction.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Disputes arising during the Olympic Games are excluded from the Tribunal's jurisdiction.
- II. Doping-related disputes are heard by the Tribunal under the National Anti-Doping Act 2022.
- III. Election disputes are within the Tribunal's jurisdiction.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Sports Initiatives and Performance

India's sports sector is coordinated through the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, which serves as the nodal ministry for sport. The National Sports Policy sets out three broad aims: to improve the quality of sports training, to promote participation in sport, and to increase the number of athletes competing internationally. A range of government initiatives works towards these aims, and they operate at different levels of sport. Some are directed at the wider population, while others focus on particular groups, such as young people. Indian athletes have recently won medals in major international competitions, including the Paris Olympics and the Paris Paralympics. India has also produced strong results in chess, and players from the country have reached the top of

international competition. The initiatives in this area are therefore not limited to a single sport or a single age group. Each one has its own purpose, and together they form part of the framework through which the government seeks to strengthen Indian sport in the country. The government's approach therefore combines broad participation programmes with more targeted support for athletes who have reached the highest level. Each of these measures has a specific target group, and the groups differ in age and level of performance.

Q1.

Which scheme identifies and supports athletes with potential to win medals at the Olympic Games?

- (A) Khelo India
- (B) KIRTI
- (C) TOPS
- (D) Fit India Movement

Q2.

Which initiative encourages mass participation in fitness activities?

- (A) Khelo India
- (B) Fit India Movement
- (C) KIRTI
- (D) TOPS

Q3.

Which Indian athlete won bronze in two 10 metre air pistol events at the 2024 Paris Olympics?

- (A) Aman Sehrawat
- (B) D Gukesh
- (C) Praveen Kumar
- (D) Manu Bhaker

Q4.

Assertion (A): Viswanathan Anand was the first Indian Grandmaster to win the FIDE World Chess Championship.

Reason (R): D Gukesh was the first Indian to win the FIDE World Chess Championship.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Khelo India	A. Gold in high jump at the 2024 Paris Paralympics
II. Mission Olympic Cell	B. Defeated China's Ding Liren in the 2024 FIDE World Chess Championship
III. Praveen Kumar	C. Works within the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports
IV. D Gukesh	D. Identifies and develops athletes at grassroots and elite levels

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Indian sports initiatives:

- I. KIRTI is aimed at school children aged 9 to 18.
- II. India won two silver medals at the Paris Olympics.
- III. Khelo India was launched in 2017.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. TOPS was launched in 2014.
- II. KIRTI is meant for athletes above the age of 18.
- III. D Gukesh became world champion at the age of 18.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Pax Silica and Critical Minerals: MCQ practice

Critical minerals and advanced technology have become matters of strategic planning. A United States-led multilateral framework, Pax Silica, aims to build a secure, resilient and innovation-oriented global technology ecosystem, and India is set to join it. The framework is designed to counter vulnerabilities in critical technology supply chains and to reduce over-dependence on coercive or unreliable sources. Its key objectives include minimising strategic vulnerabilities arising from concentrated supply chains, safeguarding sensitive and emerging technologies from misuse, and promoting secure, interoperable and trusted technology networks among partner countries. Its scope covers semiconductors, AI infrastructure, advanced manufacturing, compute and data logistics. Within India, the National Critical Minerals Mission seeks to enhance domestic exploration, reduce import dependence and develop processing and recycling capabilities. The mission also encourages public sector and private companies to acquire mineral assets abroad, aims to enhance trade with resource-rich countries, and lists regulatory and financial support among its key objectives. A dedicated body, Khanij Bidesh India Ltd, is responsible for identifying and acquiring overseas assets related to critical minerals. Exploration is also extended to the Indian Ocean seabed under the Samudravaan Project, which is aimed at finding critical minerals there. The mission also lists processing and recycling capabilities and overseas mineral acquisitions among its key objectives.

Q1.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for the National Critical Minerals Mission?

- (A) Ministry of Steel
- (B) Ministry of Mines
- (C) Ministry of Power
- (D) Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Q2.

In which district is India's first lithium site, Salal-Haimana, located?

- (A) Korba
- (B) Bilaspur
- (C) Reasi
- (D) Raipur

Q3.

Which state hosts India's first lithium auctioned site?

- (A) Chhattisgarh
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Jammu and Kashmir
- (D) Rajasthan

Q4.

Assertion (A): Israel is one of the members of Pax Silica.

Reason (R): Singapore is one of the members of Pax Silica.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Minerals Security Partnership	A. Argentina, Bolivia and Chile
II. Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET)	B. Five lithium brine blocks in Argentina
III. Khanij Bidesh India Ltd (KABIL)	C. Semiconductors, AI and wireless communication
IV. Lithium triangle	D. Only developing-country member: India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Critical Minerals Mission runs from FY 2020-21 to 2025-26.
- II. The United Kingdom is one of the members of Pax Silica.
- III. A law enacted in 1957 enables mining concessions for critical minerals.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Minerals Security Partnership was launched in 2022.
- II. The Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology was launched by India and the US in 2024.
- III. Japan is one of the members of Pax Silica.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Schemes and Governance Platforms: MCQ practice

Government schemes in India address goals as varied as tourism, skill training, maternal health and urban livelihoods. Swadesh Darshan is a central sector scheme that aims at the integrated

development of theme-based tourist circuits. Its major circuits include the Buddhist, Heritage, Eco-Tourism, Himalayan, Coastal and Desert circuits. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana provides short-term skill training, upskilling and recognition of prior learning to young people. Its nodal ministry is the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, and candidate records are kept on the Skill India Portal. A CAG audit of the scheme found that training programmes were not adequately aligned with actual labour market needs, and that many certified candidates possessed only basic literacy despite job roles that required technical education. The same audit noted duplicate bank accounts and identical photographs among candidate records. A separate scheme gives a conditional cash transfer to pregnant women and lactating mothers to improve maternal health and nutrition. Beneficiaries must register their pregnancy, complete at least one ante-natal check-up and have an institutional delivery. Governance platforms also play a role in delivery. One such platform tracks the status of mega projects, their timelines and bottlenecks, and the Prime Minister's Office provides overall oversight of it. Its coordination role spans several agencies and ministries.

Q1.

In which year was Swadesh Darshan launched?

- (A) 2017
- (B) 2015
- (C) 2020
- (D) 2022

Q2.

According to the CAG audit of PMKVY (2015-2022), what share of funds released for state components remained unspent?

- (A) Nearly 5%
- (B) Nearly 41%
- (C) Nearly 95%
- (D) Nearly 20%

Q3.

Under which umbrella scheme was PMMVY incorporated in 2022?

- (A) Mission Indradhanush
- (B) Samagra Shiksha
- (C) Mission Antyodaya
- (D) Mission Shakti

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. PRASHAD	A. Destination-centric and sustainable tourism
II. Swadesh Darshan 2.0	B. Infrastructure at major pilgrimage and heritage sites
III. PM SVANidhi	C. Conditional cash transfer for pregnant women and lactating mothers
IV. PMMVY	D. Affordable working capital loans for street vendors

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The PMKVY audit found that the placement rate was only 41 per cent.
- II. PM SVANidhi was launched in 2015.
- III. PRAGATI is a two-tier platform.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. PMMVY targets pregnant women and lactating mothers aged 19 years and above.
- II. Swadesh Darshan 2.0 shifted from destination-centric to circuit-based infrastructure.
- III. About 95 per cent of PMKVY candidate records had invalid or missing information.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Defence, Diplomacy and Resources: MCQ practice

India and Germany have a strategic partnership now spanning a quarter century, and the German Chancellor's first official visit to India was held to mark that milestone. The visit also comes ahead of the upcoming 75 years of diplomatic relations between the two countries. The two countries signed agreements covering defence, trade, technology, mobility and Indo-Pacific engagement. In defence, a joint declaration of intent was signed to develop a roadmap for defence industrial cooperation, with focus areas that include co-development and co-production of defence platforms. Germany also expressed interest in taking part in Indian naval and air exercises, including the air combat exercise Tarang Shakti, and in activities connected with the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium. The education agenda includes the Indo-German Comprehensive Roadmap on Higher Education, and academic collaboration, skill development and research mobility are priorities. Business travel and academic exchanges are to be promoted. The visit took place in Gujarat, and the partnership's broader cooperation covers climate, education and research. A green and sustainable development partnership aligns bilateral climate cooperation with the Paris Climate Agreement goals, with focus areas such as renewable energy, climate finance and sustainable development. An Indo-German Science and Technology Centre supports research, development and industrial innovation, and the partnership also covers people-to-people ties.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Germany announced a visa-free transit facility for Indian passport holders.
- II. The Indo-Sri Lanka Accord was signed on 29 July 1987.
- III. The India-Pakistan agreement on nuclear installations was signed on 31 December 1990.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q2.

Which European organisation partners with DRDO for the Eurodrone MALE UAV programme?

- (A) NATO
- (B) European Space Agency
- (C) Airbus
- (D) OCCAR

Q3.

Assertion (A): India and Pakistan exchange lists of their nuclear installations every year.

Reason (R): Bilateral trade between India and Germany crossed USD 50 billion in 2024.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Operation Pawan was launched to enforce peace and disarm militant groups in Sri Lanka, primarily the LTTE.
- II. The Indus Waters Treaty was signed in 1991.
- III. The Pinaka LRGR-120 was flight-tested at Chandipur, Odisha.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

In which year was the Indian Peacekeeping Force (IPKF) withdrawn from Sri Lanka?

- (A) 1987
- (B) 1988
- (C) 1990
- (D) 1991

Q6.

Which organisation brokered the Indus Waters Treaty of 1960?

- (A) United Nations
- (B) World Bank
- (C) International Monetary Fund
- (D) Asian Development Bank

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pinaka LRGR-120	A. Gandhinagar, Gujarat
II. Sawalkot hydropower project	B. Full rights to India
III. Eastern rivers	C. Long-range artillery weapon system
IV. German Chancellor's first official visit	D. 1856 MW run-of-river project on the Chenab

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Type-in-the-answer passages

Crisis and Sanctions Recall

Venezuela is located on the northern coast of South America and is bordered by Colombia, Brazil, Guyana and the Atlantic Ocean. The country's official language is Spanish, and its economy has depended heavily on oil revenue. Venezuela has been facing a deep political and economic collapse for several years. Hyperinflation, prolonged power outages, food shortages and a breakdown of healthcare services have caused severe humanitarian distress. The crisis escalated when Juan Guaido, the head of the National Assembly, declared himself Acting President. His claim directly challenged President Nicolas Maduro. Under Maduro's leadership, Venezuela's economy suffered a drastic contraction, which is largely blamed on corruption, poor governance and overdependence on oil. Presidential elections were widely criticised as unfair and non-transparent, and opposition leaders were barred, imprisoned or exiled. The opposition-controlled National Assembly rejected the legitimacy of the election results. Guaido's declaration as interim president gained international recognition from several Western countries, while nations like Russia and China continued supporting Maduro. Many Venezuelans have left the country, mainly for other Latin American countries, to escape these conditions. US sanctions drastically limited Venezuela's oil exports to the United States, forcing Caracas to seek alternative buyers. Caracas has rejected all allegations and has argued that the United States is weaponising migration and drug enforcement narratives to justify regime change. Venezuela maintains that the intervention reflects geopolitical interests rather than genuine concern.

Q1.

Which state-owned oil firm did Washington target with comprehensive sanctions? (one word or acronym)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year were Venezuela's presidential elections widely criticised as unfair and non-transparent?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of Venezuela's currency? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term did the opposition-controlled National Assembly use to describe Maduro? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was Nicolas Maduro sworn in for his controversial second term?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Monroe Doctrine proclaimed? (year)

Answer: _____

Minerals and Arctic Routes: Typed Answers

Climate change is reshaping the Arctic. Melting sea ice is opening new maritime corridors through waters that were once difficult to navigate. Shipping along these corridors could shorten travel times between the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, while lowering fuel and shipping costs. The new routes could also allow ships to avoid some of the chokepoints that currently shape global trade. Control over these sea lanes is expected to influence future trade flows and the projection of naval

power. Greenland's own resources add to the region's importance. The island holds mineral wealth that is vital for semiconductors, renewable energy equipment and defence systems. Many Western economies see new sources of these minerals as a way to diversify supply chains that are heavily concentrated elsewhere. This push forms part of a wider effort to decouple sensitive economic sectors from rival suppliers. China is also investing in Arctic research and infrastructure, which signals long-term interest in the region. Taken together, the changing Arctic is becoming a centre of economic and strategic competition, and the outcome will shape which countries gain leverage over future trade.

Q1.

Which country currently dominates the rare earth elements market? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which emerging Arctic shipping route is linked to melting Arctic ice? (name the route)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from the Suez Canal, which canal could new Arctic routes help ships bypass? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term does China use to label itself in relation to the Arctic? (three words, hyphen allowed)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the abbreviation of the strategic gap named after Greenland, Iceland and the United Kingdom? (abbreviation only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What was Pituffik Space Base formerly known as? (two words)

Answer: _____

Membership and Gaza governance bodies

Membership of the Board of Peace follows a set of rules. A country that joins must consent to be bound by the Board's charter, which makes the obligation binding rather than optional. Membership is offered in two forms, one based on rotation and one based on a reported contribution. Alongside the Board, Gaza is to be run through several linked bodies. A National Committee for the Administration of Gaza is responsible for day-to-day civil administration and is made up of Palestinian figures chosen for their political independence. A separate International Stabilization Force handles security and helps train police. A High Representative acts as the link between the Board and the Gaza committee on the ground. A Gaza Executive Board, described as a supporting operational body, coordinates activities on the ground. Each of these bodies has a specific job, and together they are designed to connect international oversight with administration on the ground. The arrangement is meant to support Gaza's transition from conflict to reconstruction. The Board is led from the top, with the United States playing a central role in its formation. The rules on the Board's membership and finances are set out in its charter, which covers dispute settlement as well. Its initial authorisation is time-limited.

Q1.

Which Bulgarian diplomat is named High Representative for Gaza? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who chairs the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many members does the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many countries are listed as members of the Gaza Executive Board? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the tenure of rotational membership of the Board of Peace, in years? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What reported contribution, in USD billion, gives a country permanent membership of the Board? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year does the Board's initial authorisation end? (year)

Answer: _____

India-Mauritius Recall

Mauritius occupies a strategic position in the Western Indian Ocean, and India has steadily deepened its partnership with the island nation. The relationship spans security, trade and culture. On the security side, India has helped Mauritius strengthen its maritime capabilities, including coastal radar stations and integration into an Indian Ocean information-sharing network. Mauritius also takes part in naval drills led by India and is a member of the Colombo Security Conclave with India and other Indian Ocean neighbours. Economic ties are equally important. Mauritius serves as a gateway for Indian trade and investment into Africa, given its membership of the African Continental Free Trade Area. A bilateral economic agreement between the two countries has encouraged closer commercial links, and Mauritius is a major source of investment into India. Culturally, the relationship is reflected in institutions such as the Mahatma Gandhi Institute and the Indira Gandhi Centre for Indian Culture on the island. Together, these areas show how India uses partnerships in the Indian Ocean to support its wider regional interests.

Q1.

In which year were diplomatic relations between India and Mauritius established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Mahatma Gandhi visit Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Indira Gandhi Centre for Indian Culture established in Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Mauritius was the second largest source of FDI into India in FY 2024-25, after which country?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the bilateral trade between India and Mauritius in FY 2024-25 (in USD million)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

India upgraded the airstrip of which island into a full-length airfield?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Comprehensive Economic Cooperation and Partnership Agreement signed between India and Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Yemen's divide and Houthi rise: short answers

Yemen has long been divided between its northern and southern regions, which differ in religious traditions, social structures and systems of governance. Foreign influence and colonial legacies reinforced these differences. Yemen lies in the south-western Arabian Peninsula, bordering Saudi Arabia and Oman, and it is flanked by the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden. Its location gives it strategic importance for shipping. During the Cold War, Yemen existed as two separate states. The Yemeni Arab Republic in the north received support from the United States and Saudi Arabia, while the People's Democratic Republic of Yemen in the south was backed by the Soviet Union. The two states later merged to form a single republic, but power remained heavily centralised, creating resentment in the south. Southern leaders attempted secession, leading to a brief civil conflict. Southern discontent later returned through a movement demanding greater autonomy or independence for the south. In the north, the Houthi movement grew out of the Zaydi Shia population. Its insurgency began after its founder was killed by Yemeni forces. Later, the movement seized large parts of the country, including the capital. Today the Houthis control the north and west, the Southern Transitional Council holds much of the south and east, and the internationally recognised government controls only limited areas in the north. The country's divisions therefore continue to shape its politics and its prospects for peace.

Q1.

In which year did the two Yemeni states merge to form the Republic of Yemen? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Southern leaders attempt secession, leading to a brief civil conflict? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Southern Movement (Al-Hirak) formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who was the founder of the Houthi movement, killed by Yemeni forces in Saada in 2004? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Houthis capture Sanaa, forcing President Hadi to flee abroad the following year? (year of capture)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In 2015, the Houthis expanded their control in western Yemen to include which strait? (name of strait)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Yemeni leader did the Houthis kill in 2017 for switching allegiance to the Saudi-led coalition? (full name)

Answer: _____

Awards and Honours Recall

India's civilian honours include the Padma awards, which are announced every year on the eve of Republic Day. They recognise achievements in all fields involving public service and come in three categories: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri, listed in descending order of rank. The Bharat Ratna is described as India's highest civilian award. Gallantry awards recognise bravery shown by members of the armed forces, and they are kept in separate wartime and peacetime categories. Wartime Gallantry awards were instituted on 26 January 1950, while peacetime awards came later. Gallantry awards are announced twice a year, on Republic Day and Independence Day. Eligibility covers officers of all ranks in the Army, Navy and Air Force, reserve forces, the Territorial Army, and personnel providing nursing services under these forces. The order of precedence places the Param Vir Chakra first, followed by the Ashoka Chakra, Mahavir Chakra, Kirti Chakra, Vir Chakra and Shaurya Chakra. Gallantry awards are given for acts of bravery, while the Padma awards are given for service and achievement in public life. Each year the honours list covers a broad range of fields, and understanding the rank order of these awards helps in answering questions on both civilian and military honours.

Q1.

In which year was the Peacetime Gallantry Award instituted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many Padma Vibhushan awards were announced for 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many armed forces personnel were conferred Gallantry Awards in 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which gallantry award is India's highest peacetime gallantry award?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian, the first Indian on the ISS, was honoured with the Ashok Chakra?

Answer: _____

Q6.

From which year has 26 November been observed as Constitution Day? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which European Commission president was among the Chief Guests for Republic Day 2026? (full name)

Answer: _____

Caste Discrimination and Safeguards

Caste-based discrimination in higher education has drawn sustained national attention. Figures reported by the University Grants Commission show that complaints of caste discrimination rose sharply in recent years, and the number of pending cases also grew, even though disposal rates stayed high. Two high-profile cases have highlighted allegations of institutional caste exclusion across the country. Such discrimination is seen to erode equality, dignity and fraternity, and to undermine trust in democratic institutions. Caste bias and poor schooling limit access to elite institutions for SC, ST and OBC students, which hinders social mobility. Marginalised communities also face higher dropout rates because of academic, financial and psychological pressures, while reserved category stigma can produce anxiety, low self-esteem and poor academic outcomes. Support structures are not always effective either, since SC/ST cells in universities often lack autonomy and enforcement, weakening grievance redressal. The constitutional framework responds to these problems. Article 14 guarantees equality before law, Article 15 prohibits discrimination and permits affirmative action, and Article 17 abolishes untouchability. Several statutes add enforcement, including the Protection of Civil Rights Act, which imposes penalties for practising untouchability, the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, which sets strict punishments, and the Right to Education Act, which promotes non-discriminatory access to education. Together, these measures combine constitutional principles with statutory penalties and guarantees of access to education.

Q1.

By what percentage did UGC-reported caste-discrimination complaints rise between 2019-20 and 2023-24? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many caste-discrimination cases were pending at UGC in 2023-24?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many caste-discrimination complaints were received in 2019-20?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the Rohith Vemula case occur?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Article of the Constitution directs the promotion of educational and economic interests of weaker sections? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Protection of Civil Rights Act enacted?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act enacted?

Answer: _____

Funding Schemes Recall

Access to finance is a central concern for new businesses, and the government has created several instruments to address it. Some instruments support the early steps of a venture, such as testing

an idea, building a prototype or entering a market. Others help a recognised startup obtain loans by offering a guarantee to the lender. A larger instrument works through a corpus that supports new companies. Such instruments are managed by the department that promotes industry and internal trade under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry. Government instruments of this kind are designed to reach firms at different points of their growth. Students should note the timeline of each measure, the amount it commits and the kind of startup it reaches. Precise recall of names, dates and figures matters, because two similar schemes can be confused in examinations. Each scheme must be read against its own purpose, since support for early activities differs from a guarantee on loans.

Q1.

In which month and year was the Fund of Funds for Startups introduced?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the corpus of the Fund of Funds for Startups, in crore? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which date is National Startup Day observed? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which scheme provides financial assistance for proof of concept and prototype development? (scheme name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Through which type of eligible institutions is seed fund assistance channelled? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Fund of Funds for Startups aims to enhance access to which kind of capital? (two words)

Answer: _____

Tariffs and Market Access: Quick Recall

The India-EU free trade agreement is built around the reduction of customs duties on goods that move between the two economies. The European Union is already one of India's largest trading partners, so the changes affect a large volume of commerce. Under the agreement, duties on most bilateral trade are being removed, giving Indian exporters better access to European markets while giving European producers access to Indian markets over time.

The benefits are not spread evenly across sectors. Labour-intensive industries in India, including textiles, apparel, leather and footwear, are expected to gain from lower entry barriers into Europe. Some products are treated more carefully. High-value items such as luxury cars and premium wines are not opened immediately; instead, their tariffs fall in stages, and quotas limit how many vehicles can enter at the lower rate each year. India also keeps some farm products outside the tariff cuts to protect rural livelihoods.

Machinery, chemicals and pharmaceuticals are among the categories whose import duties into India will be phased out, so European exporters will benefit. The agreement remains subject to ratification by the Indian Parliament and European bodies, so its full effect will depend on how commitments are implemented. Both sides present the deal as a way to diversify trade partnerships in an uncertain global environment.

Q1.

What percentage of EU customs duties on Indian exports will be eliminated under the FTA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

After five years, what will be the import tariff on luxury cars priced above EUR 15,000? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the annual tariff rate quota for luxury cars, in number of units?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the maximum current Indian tariff on machinery that will be phased out? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Approximately how much will EU exporters save annually from India's tariff phase-out? (in EUR billion)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Darjeeling Tea, name the iconic product whose geographical indication is protected under the parallel GI agreement.

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was India-EU ties upgraded to a Strategic Partnership at The Hague Summit? (year)

Answer: _____

Global and Indian Fertility Context

Fertility trends are now a global concern, not only a feature of developed economies. The United Nations Population Fund publishes its State of World Population report, which tracks population data across countries. Fertility rates vary widely: some countries record very high levels, while economies such as South Korea, Hong Kong and Singapore record some of the lowest. Ageing is also a global trend, and the elderly share of the population is high in Japan and Europe. India's fertility has fallen below replacement level, but regional differences remain, with some states above replacement and others, such as Kerala and Tamil Nadu, below it. Figures cited for India show that financial stress is the main reason given for having fewer children, followed by housing and job concerns. Schemes such as the National Population Policy 2000 set the goal of replacement-level fertility and focus on voluntary choice and access to contraception. India's national policies also promote birth spacing, contraceptive use and institutional deliveries. A proposal to raise the legal age of marriage for girls aims to reduce early childbearing. Together, these measures aim to balance voluntary choice with maternal and child health.

Q1.

What is the current world population according to UNFPA's State of World Population 2025 (in billion)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year is the global TFR projected to reach the replacement level of 2.1?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was India's fertility rate in 2025?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which above-replacement state has the highest fertility rate among those listed in the booklet?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage of India's population is of working age (15-64 years) (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was UNFPA renamed as the United Nations Population Fund?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What legal age of marriage for girls does the proposal under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006 seek (in years)?

Answer: _____

UNCLOS and ocean zones

The law of the sea rests on a simple idea: the closer a space lies to the coast, the greater a state's control over it. A state has full sovereignty over its territorial sea. Beyond that lies a zone in which the state holds the right to exploit all economic resources. Further still lie the high seas, where vessels of every nation may sail freely. The 1982 Convention on the Law of the Sea sets out the legal framework within which all activities in the oceans and seas must be carried out. It is often described as a constitution for the oceans. The Convention also created new institutions at the international level. One of these is a judicial body that settles disputes about how the Convention is interpreted. Another protects the marine environment from harmful effects of deep-seabed activities. A further body facilitates the establishment of the outer edge of the continental shelf. Continental shelf rights can extend beyond the basic zone limits, which makes the outer edge of the shelf a matter of legal importance. The Convention provides a process for determining that edge, and the bodies it created apply its rules in practice. The Convention is also supported by implementing agreements on particular issues, such as deep seabed mining and the management of fish stocks. Taken together, these rules form many layers of law that govern the oceans, and all users of the seas rely on this shared framework.

Q1.

How many parties does the 1982 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many new institutions did UNCLOS create at the international level? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the breadth of the Exclusive Economic Zone? (in nautical miles)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which independent judicial body under UNCLOS handles disputes over the Convention's interpretation? (name the body)

Answer: _____

Q5.

As per the booklet (January 2026), how many countries had ratified the UN High Seas Treaty (BBNJ Agreement) when it entered into force? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many kilometres is one nautical mile? (in km)

Answer: _____

PSLV profile recall

The Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle is widely known as the workhorse of the Indian Space Research Organisation. It is a medium-lift launcher with four stages, and it has carried many national missions, including lunar and Mars missions. Its design mixes two kinds of propulsion, since some stages burn solid fuel while others use liquid propellants. Because of this mix, it became the first Indian launch vehicle to be equipped with liquid stages, a milestone for the national programme. The rocket also holds a notable record of its own, having carried a very large number of satellites on a single flight. It is able to place heavy satellites into a Sun-synchronous orbit, which suits Earth observation work. Over the years it has launched satellites for both government and commercial customers, reflecting its reliability and flexibility. The rocket's stages fire one after another, and the upper stages must deliver steady thrust for satellites to reach their planned orbit. This makes the vehicle an important tool for both national missions and international customers. Its success has made it a central part of India's launch plans, and it continues to be a core vehicle in the country's space efforts.

Q1.

How many satellites did PSLV carry on a single flight in 2017? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did PSLV achieve its first successful launch? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Name the remote sensing satellite carried on PSLV's first successful launch.

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is PSLV's payload capability to a 600 km Sun-synchronous orbit? (in kg)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which engine powers the liquid second stage of PSLV? (name of the engine)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which PSLV launch, designated PSLV-Cxx, carried Aditya-L1 on 2 September 2023? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was Chandrayaan-1, a PSLV-launched lunar probe, launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Anti-doping and performance recall

Anti-doping rules in sport combine national law with international standards. A national agency under the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports monitors doping control programmes across the country. India's standalone anti-doping law is designed to comply with the code of the World Anti-Doping Agency and gives authorities powers for search, seizure and disciplinary action. An international convention adopted by UNESCO urges nations to enact laws that eliminate drug use in sport, and it has been accepted by many countries, including India. When disagreements arise in the sports world, they can be taken to a specialised body that offers a fair and quick way to resolve them. Sport in India is also supported by government initiatives. The Fit India Movement encourages mass participation in fitness activities, while Khelo India identifies and develops athletes at grassroots and elite levels. The National Olympic Committee is the sole governing body for Olympic sports in India. Indian athletes won several medals at the Paris Olympics and Paralympics, and young players have also made headlines in chess and shooting. Talent identification programmes aimed at school children are meant to find promising players in every corner of India.

Q1.

In which year was the Court of Arbitration for Sport set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who is the President of the Indian Olympic Association? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many medals did India win at the Paris Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What position did India secure in the Paris Olympics medals tally? (rank)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many countries, including India, are recorded under the UNESCO International Convention against Doping in Sport? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Fit India Movement launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian chess player became the world's youngest chess champion at 18? (surname or name)

Answer: _____

Economy and Rankings Check

India has climbed several global economic rankings in recent years. It overtook Japan to become the fourth-largest economy measured by nominal GDP, and it is projected to move ahead of another major economy to take third place. Its growth is described as the fastest among major economies, supported by strong domestic demand and a services-led model. Services form the largest share of

the economy, followed by industry and agriculture. Food prices also entered a phase of deflation, meaning a sustained fall in the general price level. The Reserve Bank of India reported that states' consolidated fiscal deficit rose to 3.3 per cent of GDP in 2024-25. Rankings also measure other aspects of national standing. The Henley Passport Index ranks passports by the number of destinations that holders can reach without a prior visa, whether visa-free or on arrival. It was first launched in 2006 and is published by a London-based firm. NITI Aayog's Export Preparedness Index, now in its fourth edition, assesses how ready Indian states and union territories are to export. It is organised around four pillars: export infrastructure, business ecosystem, policy and governance, and export performance. The index supports India's goal of reaching one trillion dollars in merchandise exports by 2030.

Q1.

What percentage weight does the business ecosystem pillar carry in NITI Aayog's Export Preparedness Index? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Singapore tops the Henley Passport Index 2026; how many countries does its passport give access to without a prior visa? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country tied with Japan for second place in the Henley Passport Index 2026?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Food prices entered deflation for the first time since which year?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year is India projected to surpass Germany to become the third-largest economy? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is India's rank in per capita nominal GDP? (rank number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which large state is named first in the 'Leaders' category of the Export Preparedness Index?

Answer: _____

Monroe Doctrine and Multilateralism

The Monroe Doctrine is a policy that the United States announced in the early nineteenth century. Its first purpose was defensive, but later it was used to justify American military action in the region. The Roosevelt Corollary extended this idea, saying the United States could keep stability in the Western Hemisphere. The United Nations exists to maintain international peace and security, yet its work is often limited. Permanent members can block resolutions, and action frequently stalls when a major power is involved. The UN also faces funding problems, with unpaid dues and shortfalls for peacekeeping. Regional bodies have acted in crises without waiting for Security Council approval. Modern conflicts use hidden methods that blur the line between war and peace, and states have sometimes described military force as law enforcement. Reformers have suggested stronger accountability, limits on vetoes and public justification of decisions, and new rules for hybrid threats. Computer attacks, private contractors and proxies are among the tools used in these conflicts. Reform ideas also include a binding protocol for gray-zone threats and monitoring

of cyber attacks.

Q1.

In which year did the NotPetya cyberattack disrupt global systems? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which UN Charter article on the use of force do states bypass by redefining military force as law enforcement? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which UN Charter article is cited for preventive self-defence? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Monroe Doctrine principle bars European powers from interfering in the internal affairs of independent American states? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which reform mechanism would let a P5 veto be set aside for mass atrocities? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which regional organisation, besides NATO and the African Union, intervenes without Security Council approval? (one word)

Answer: _____

US Ties with Greenland: Typed Answer

Greenland is the world's largest island and a self-governing territory of Denmark. Greenland is one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, alongside the Faroe Islands. Its history under Danish rule began in the early eighteenth century, when an expedition led by a Danish-Norwegian missionary arrived on the island. Greenland became a self-governing territory in 1979, and it has held the right to declare independence through a referendum since 2009. The island lies between North America and Europe, a position that makes it a linchpin in the security structure linking the two continents. Greenland is not a member state of the European Union, although it is associated with the bloc as one of its overseas countries and territories. Greenlanders are considered EU citizens under that association. Greenland joined the European Community together with Denmark in 1973 but left it in 1985, and the EU has since replaced that community. The island's location is considered ideal for ground stations. Greenland's strategic significance is also linked to its critical minerals and natural resources. Denmark has taken a firm stance on its sovereignty over the island, and Greenland's status shows how location, defence and sovereignty are tied together. Taken together, these features explain why the island has become a subject of international attention.

Q1.

In which year did the US propose a \$100 million offer to Denmark for the outright purchase of Greenland?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the US-Denmark Defence Agreement concluded?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which type of satellites can Greenland's ground stations track? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which alliance's ability to monitor Russian activities in the Arctic and North Atlantic does Greenland enhance? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Ballistic Missile Early-Warning System infrastructure in Greenland enables detection of what over the Arctic? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

During which war did the US seize temporary control of Greenland? (standard name)

Answer: _____

Great Power Competition and ACI: Typed Answer

Greenland is the world's largest island and a self-governing territory of Denmark. Greenland became a self-governing territory in 1979. Greenland has held the right to declare independence through a referendum since 2009. It lies between North America and Europe, and it is described as a linchpin in Arctic and trans-Atlantic security architecture. The island has become part of wider debates about the Arctic. Melting ice is opening new maritime corridors, and control over these sea lanes is expected to shape future global trade and naval power. The new routes could reduce travel time between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans and lower fuel and shipping costs. The island's untapped rare earth reserves are important for semiconductors, renewable energy technologies and defence systems. The European Union has a legal mechanism called the Anti-Coercion Instrument, which is designed to respond when a non-EU country seeks to pressure the bloc or its members. Its objectives include ensuring that disputes are resolved through dialogue first, with escalation only if necessary. Greenland joined the European Community together with Denmark in 1973 but left it in 1985, and the EU has since replaced that community. Greenlanders are considered EU citizens, and the island is associated with the bloc as one of its overseas countries and territories.

Q1.

Which country's President urged the EU to invoke the Anti-Coercion Instrument for the first time? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The Anti-Coercion Instrument is primarily a tool of what kind? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country has heavily militarised its Arctic coastline? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country is investing in Arctic research and infrastructure? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Anti-Coercion Instrument aims to deter economic coercion and protect the EU's strategic ____ and policy space. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the countermeasure category covering restrictions on foreign direct investment? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the Anti-Coercion Instrument, what kind of response can be used if coercion persists? (two words)

Answer: _____

US 20-point Gaza plan: recall

A twenty-point plan has been proposed to end the war in Gaza. Its formal name is the Comprehensive Plan to End the Gaza Conflict. Its proposer had held talks with the Israeli Prime Minister before putting it forward. The plan imagines a Gaza that is free of militant activity, so that it poses no threat to neighbouring states. Its early provisions concern a halt to military operations, the release of people held by each side, and the immediate entry of aid. The aid is meant to help rebuild essential infrastructure. The plan also proposes a special economic zone with favourable trade terms, which would be supported by outside investment and would generate employment. Gaza would be governed for a time by Palestinians working under an international board. The plan also points towards self-determination and statehood for Palestinians, with a peaceful political future to be sought through talks between Israelis and Palestinians. Each of these elements is set out as one of the plan's twenty points. The wider dispute has a long history, and Britain was granted a mandate over Palestine after the First World War. Gaza is described as a place where Israel's military would withdraw as stability grows. Gaza's residents are free to stay, leave or return.

Q1.

Within how many hours of Israel's formal acceptance must all hostages, alive or deceased, be released? (hours)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many Palestinian life-sentence prisoners is Israel to free under the plan? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Israeli Prime Minister did the plan's proposer hold talks with before proposing it? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the abbreviation of the force deployed to secure Gaza and train its police? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which country leads the talks on a peaceful political future between Israelis and Palestinians? (country)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What kind of platform does the plan create to promote religious harmony? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What kind of committee temporarily governs Gaza under the plan? (one word)

Answer: _____

Chagos Sovereignty Deal and the Diego Garcia Base

Britain has agreed to transfer sovereignty of the Chagos Islands to Mauritius. The UK and Mauritius reached this agreement, and the UK ceded its claims over the archipelago. The arrangement is not a complete handover, because the UK keeps sovereign rights over Diego Garcia, where a joint UK-US military base is located. Under the agreement, the base will remain operational for an initial period. The Chagos Islands are an archipelago in the Indian Ocean. The United States has raised concerns about the arrangement. Washington sees a change in sovereignty as a matter that could affect its strategic position, and that concern is part of a wider debate. The issue pits decolonisation against security interests. It also reflects a tension between international legal norms and realpolitik. Geopolitics adds another layer. Competition in the Indian Ocean region involves China, the United States and other regional powers. The UK has insisted that the issue should remain a bilateral matter. In 2015, Mauritius began legal proceedings against the UK at the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague, challenging the UK's sovereignty claims and the forced removal of Chagossians. Mauritius is an island nation located in the Western Indian Ocean, and India has backed Mauritius's territorial claim over the archipelago.

Q1.

How many islands make up the Chagos archipelago? (answer in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years will the joint UK-US base at Diego Garcia remain operational for an initial period? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which part of the Indian Ocean is Diego Garcia located? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Apart from strategic autonomy, what else does the US concern about a sovereignty change relate to? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Trump criticised the plan, citing the strategic ____ of the US military base. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did Mauritius gain independence from British rule? (year)

Answer: _____

India-UAE Ties Beyond Trade

The partnership between India and the United Arab Emirates now extends across trade, energy, defence, nuclear technology and digital policy. Both governments have agreed to create new trade corridors and platforms to support commerce. Remittances sent home by workers from the

Emirates are an important part of the financial relationship. In energy, an Emirati gas company has signed a supply agreement with an Indian refiner. Military cooperation is also growing, with plans for joint training and work on defence technology. The two sides have also agreed to cooperate in emerging security domains. Scientific cooperation is part of the agenda as well, including a joint project in artificial intelligence and high-performance computing. Cultural ties are visible in a traditional Hindu stone temple in Abu Dhabi, the first of its kind in the UAE. India has also passed a recent law that opens the way for wider international nuclear collaboration. Digital cooperation is also being explored, including a proposal to store critical national data offshore. The UAE's President visited India recently, and the agreements were announced during that visit. The initiatives promote new trade corridors and platforms. Energy, defence and digital policy are being developed in parallel. Taken together, these steps widen the relationship beyond traditional trade.

Q1.

What was India-UAE bilateral trade in FY 2024-25, in US\$ billion?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which UAE air base has India been given access to for refuelling? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Indian law enacted in 2025 enables broader international nuclear collaboration? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which Indian mission will a supercomputing cluster be set up as part of India-UAE cooperation? (name of mission)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the UAE's first traditional Hindu stone temple, located in Abu Dhabi? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

For how many years is the ADNOC Gas LNG supply agreement with HPCL? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did Estonia launch the world's first data embassy? (year)

Answer: _____

UAE Profile and Labour Rules

Its territory is organised as a federation of member emirates, and its government is led by a President and a Prime Minister. The country has a coastline on the Gulf, and its maritime boundaries are shared with other states across these waters. Its land borders are with two neighbouring countries on the peninsula. Many migrant workers live in the country, and their presence is regulated by a system in which a party inside the country holds considerable control over the worker's legal status. The arrangement can lead to exploitation, non-payment of wages, poor working conditions and restricted movement. The country operates a nuclear power plant, and it is the first of its kind in the Arab world. In trade, the UAE has a comprehensive economic partnership with India, and remittances from the UAE are an important source of funds for families in India. The two countries have also agreed to cooperate in defence and in nuclear safety. Cultural ties include a traditional Hindu stone temple in the capital city. The UAE's President has visited

India recently. The UAE has ties with several neighbours in the Gulf region, and its relations with them have been tested by recent events in Yemen.

Q1.

How many emirates make up the UAE? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the capital city of the UAE? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the currency of the UAE? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Arabic word, meaning 'sponsorship', names the system that places migrant workers under an in-country sponsor? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the Arab world's first nuclear power plant? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country, besides Qatar, shares the UAE's maritime border in the Persian Gulf? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who is the UAE's Prime Minister? (full name)

Answer: _____

Republic Day: History Recall

Republic Day is observed on 26 January, and its story is closely tied to India's freedom movement. A session of the Indian National Congress produced a resolution demanding total self-rule, sovereignty and complete independence from British rule. Congress then asked Indians to treat 26 January as a day of national pride, and the date was used in this way for many years. Freedom eventually arrived, and afterwards people reconsidered what the day should signify. The nation's legal framework was built through the work of the Constituent Assembly, which produced the Constitution of India. That Constitution replaced the earlier legal arrangements of colonial rule, so the country moved from being a Dominion of the Crown to a sovereign, democratic republic. Celebrations begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. Today the main celebrations take place at Kartavya Path, formerly Rajpath, in New Delhi, where a parade is held. The celebrations end with the Beating Retreat ceremony at Vijay Chowk. The 2026 parade showcased 30 cultural tableaux under the theme 150 Years of Vande Mataram. The parade showcased Constitutional values, and the day therefore recalls both the long struggle for freedom and the adoption of a constitutional system.

Q1.

In which city was the Indian National Congress session held that passed the Poorna Swaraj resolution in December 1929?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the name of the resolution passed by the INC in December 1929 that demanded total self-rule and complete independence?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Constitution of India adopted by the Constituent Assembly?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Act of 1935 was repealed by the Constitution when it came into effect?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did India gain independence from British rule?

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which calendar day and month is Constitution Day observed?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did the Constitution come into effect?

Answer: _____

Flag Ceremony Recall

The Tricolour, India's National Flag, is central to two national occasions held each year. Republic Day is observed on 26 January, and Independence Day is observed on 15 August. Although the flag is present at both, each ceremony has its own character and its own meaning. The Republic Day ceremony recalls the moment when India's legal system took a new shape and the nation became a sovereign, democratic republic. The Independence Day ceremony marks the end of foreign rule and the arrival of freedom. Both occasions are linked to the flag. Celebrations begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. Wreath-laying at Amar Jawan Jyoti takes place in the early morning of 26 January. The Republic Day parade is held at Kartavya Path, formerly Rajpath, in New Delhi, and the celebrations conclude on 29 January with the Beating Retreat at Vijay Chowk. The 2026 parade showcased 30 cultural tableaux under the theme 150 Years of Vande Mataram, and leading tableaux came from Maharashtra, Jammu and Kashmir, and Kerala. The address to the nation is delivered on the day before Republic Day. The 2026 celebration marks the 77th Republic Day, and the Beating Retreat marks the close of the celebrations.

Q1.

Who unfurls the National Flag on Republic Day? Give the office title.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who hoists the National Flag on Independence Day? Give the office title.

Answer: _____

Q3.

On Republic Day, the folded or rolled flag is attached to which part of the pole? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

On Independence Day, the flag is raised from which end of the pole to which end?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Unfurling is a symbolic gesture to renew commitment to the principles of which document?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Unfurling highlights India's shift from being a colony of which country?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Hoisting the flag symbolises the rise of a what?

Answer: _____

UGC: Origins and Early Structure

The University Grants Commission is a body that works in the field of higher education in India. Its formal basis is a law, and it operates as a national body with a wide reach. Its origins go back to a report prepared before the country became independent, and to a committee that was later expanded so that it could cover all Indian universities. A commission appointed after independence to examine university education also left its mark on the story, since its recommendations influenced how the body was reorganised. In the years that followed, the central government placed the UGC in charge of supervising the grants that flow to higher education institutions. Today, the Commission coordinates funding, advises the government on higher education reforms and maintains academic standards. Its work covers funding, guidance and standards, and its reach extends to every institution that receives its grants. Its members are appointed by the Central Government, and the body works with universities and colleges across the country. Over the decades, the UGC has grown from a modest committee into a national body that shapes university education. The story of its growth is therefore closely tied to the development of higher education in the country as a whole.

Q1.

In which year was the UGC formally inaugurated?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who formally inaugurated the UGC? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

From which report did the idea of the UGC evolve? (give the name of the report)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who chaired the University Education Commission of 1948?

Answer: _____

Q5.

On which model did the University Education Commission recommend restructuring the UGC? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did the government entrust the UGC with oversight of higher education grants?

Answer: _____

Concerns Over Complaints and Inquiries

The equity regulations notified by the UGC in 2026 have drawn both support and criticism. Supporters see them as a route to fairness and inclusion on campuses, while critics have examined how the framework would work in practice. Their analysis covers several areas, including the way complaints are received, the balance between protecting complainants and treating the accused fairly, and the amount of time given for an inquiry. Some observers also look at how the various parts of the process are connected to one another. The debate is part of a larger conversation about how Indian universities can tackle caste-based discrimination while maintaining a sense of security among students and staff. The regulations were framed against a background of caste-based discrimination cases that have drawn public attention in recent years. Campus bodies such as Equal Opportunity Centres are meant to promote equity and inclusion, and their role has become part of the discussion. The Supreme Court has temporarily stayed the regulations, a step that has kept the debate active. Observers from different backgrounds have offered views on how the rules could be improved in practice, and those views add to the wider conversation about equity in higher education. This is why the regulations continue to be discussed in academic and public forums.

Q1.

What kind of consequences could students and faculty fear under the framework? (one word or two words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The regulations lack explicit protection against which kinds of complaints? (give the three adjectives used in the text)

Answer: _____

Q3.

To which authority is the helpline automatically linked? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Compressed inquiry timelines may compromise the thoroughness of what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Critics fear the framework could indirectly influence the social and ____ composition of campuses. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Lack of confidentiality for the accused could expose them to what kind of harm? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The helpline's link to police may discourage what kind of open exchange on campus? (two words)

Answer: _____

Launch, Aim and Management: TITA practice

The Startup India Initiative is covered in the Polity and Governance section of the 2026 current affairs material. The topic came into the news because India marked a milestone anniversary of the programme. The booklet links this milestone with National Startup Day, which it describes as a day for celebrating entrepreneurial growth. The programme is run by a government department, and that department works within a larger ministry. The booklet also presents a table titled Terms Related to Startup Valuations. This table places labels against valuation levels, so that companies at different stages can be described using a common vocabulary. Each label is linked to a figure in dollars, and the labels appear in a fixed order in the table. The booklet treats the programme's institutional set-up and its valuation vocabulary as two separate areas of the subject. Both areas are part of its wider discussion of the initiative and of current affairs coverage in governance. Taken together, the material gives a basic picture of how the initiative is run and how startup growth is described. The same section of the booklet lists several schemes that operate under the initiative, each with its own purpose. Those schemes are presented as flagship schemes, and they cover areas such as seed funding and credit guarantees.

Q1.

In which year was the Startup India Initiative launched? (year only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the full name of DPIIT, the body that manages the initiative? (name of the department)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which ministry does DPIIT operate? (ministry name, without the words Ministry of)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is a startup with the potential to reach a valuation of 1 billion dollars in the near future called? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is a startup valued at 10 billion dollars called? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What valuation, in billion dollars, does a hectocorn represent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which month was the Startup India Initiative launched? (one word)

Answer: _____

Eligibility and Core Features: TITA practice

The core features of the Startup India Initiative are set out in a list in the booklet, with several headings under which the initiative's provisions are grouped. The headings cover who qualifies, how the initiative eases the business process, what tax benefits are available, and what kind of funding support is offered. Eligibility is described in terms of the entity's location, its age and its size, which are measured in different ways. The booklet presents these conditions as a short checklist, so that a reader can compare the criteria side by side. Ease of doing business is listed under a heading of its own, covering several measures that the booklet says streamline processes for startups. The measures are presented as part of the initiative's core features, not as a separate scheme. Tax benefits form a separate heading, and the booklet presents them as applying to

startups that meet the eligibility conditions. Funding support is listed under its own heading, which includes the Fund of Funds for Startups. Sector-specific policies appear as a further heading, and the booklet describes them as focused policies for particular fields. Taken together, the headings give a structured overview of the initiative's features, although the booklet presents each heading separately. Each heading is written as a short bulleted point in the booklet, so the details stay concise.

Q1.

A startup must have opened less than how many years ago to be eligible? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the annual turnover ceiling, in crore rupees, for an eligible startup? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

For how many consecutive financial years do eligible startups enjoy tax exemptions? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which ease of doing business measure lets a startup certify its own compliance? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which mechanism streamlines clearances for startups? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along with biotechnology and renewable energy, which sector is named in the sector-specific policies? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The Fund of Funds for Startups supports which stage of funding? (two words)

Answer: _____

Mentorship, Networking and Events: TITA practice

The Startup India Initiative's wider support system includes platforms that link startups with mentors and investors, along with a flagship event that brings the ecosystem together. One platform is described in the booklet as connecting startups, investors and mentors, and it is treated as a recent addition to the initiative. A second platform is listed alongside it, and it is described through the functions it performs for the startups it serves. The flagship event is described as bringing together a wide group of participants, including startups at different stages, investors, industry leaders and ecosystem stakeholders. The booklet also states that the event has an edition scheduled to take place, with details of its timing and location included in the same section. Readers will find the platforms and the event described briefly, each with a single line of explanation in the booklet. The section therefore brings together three themes: the connections made through platforms, the networks formed through events and the mentors who support new businesses. Each of these items is kept separate in the booklet, so that a reader can tell the platforms apart from the event.

Q1.

What does BHASKAR stand for? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the BHASKAR Platform launched? (year only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which platform connects startups, investors and mentors and aims to empower non-metro cities? (name only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which platform offers intelligent matchmaking between mentors and startups? (name only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which city is the 5th edition of the flagship event scheduled? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which month is the 5th edition of the flagship event scheduled? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which flagship event brings together startups, unicorns, soonicorns, investors and industry leaders? (name)

Answer: _____

Negative Lists and Carbon Rules

Negative lists are a feature of the India-EU agreement. Each side has listed sensitive farm goods that stay outside its tariff cuts, so that livelihoods and food security are protected. The lists are intended to keep small-scale farmers from sudden import surges.

Geographical indications also receive attention. A parallel agreement helps stop unauthorised use or imitation of iconic products in both markets.

The European Union's carbon border measure applies to selected imports, and importers must buy certificates tied to the emissions embedded in their goods. An earlier phase required only reporting, without any payment. India has been given an assurance on its treatment under the measure, and a cooperation group will help verify carbon footprints. Indian industries are also receiving European support for decarbonisation.

The mechanism is part of a wider climate package in the EU, aligned with its net-zero targets. It seeks to prevent carbon leakage, meaning companies relocating production to countries with weaker emission norms. Among its objectives is a level playing field, so that imported goods face a carbon cost comparable to EU-made products. Indian exporters also face stringent EU requirements for pesticide residues, certification and labelling. Data governance differences between the EU and India have also been noted.

Q1.

Which grain appears on the negative lists of both India and the European Union?

Answer: _____

Q2.

How much, in EUR million, has the EU pledged to help Indian industries decarbonise?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which years made up the earlier phase in which CBAM required only emissions reporting? (format: YYYY-YYYY)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Name the CBAM-covered sector listed immediately after cement.

Answer: _____

Q5.

What acronym names the carbon market whose price the CBAM certificate price follows?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Name the last sector in the list of CBAM-covered sectors.

Answer: _____

Q7.

Where must a carbon tax have been paid for an importer to receive a credit under CBAM? (two words)

Answer: _____

Strategic Agenda and US Tariffs

India and the European Union have agreed on a joint strategic agenda that looks beyond trade. Its goal is to change the relationship from a mainly trade-oriented engagement into a broader, multi-dimensional strategic partnership. The agenda is described as a structured roadmap for managing geopolitical uncertainty, economic fragmentation and rising protectionism.

Its initiatives are grouped into pillars. The economic pillar stresses effective implementation of the trade agreement, with the aim of linking India to a very large combined market. Other pillars cover technology cooperation, joint defence work, cross-border connectivity and people-focused measures such as skills and mobility. The plan also refers to joint development of advanced technologies.

The US factor is also important. After tariff measures from Washington hit Indian goods, India is seeking to rely less on the American market. The European market is presented as a stable, rules-based alternative, and the agreement is said to offer a buffer against changes in US trade policy.

Connectivity and infrastructure feature prominently, including a corridor linking India with Europe through the Middle East and the EU's infrastructure financing efforts in India and Africa. Cooperation on space and cyber issues is also part of the plan. The agenda is also linked to the wider partnership between India and the EU, which has deepened over the years.

Q1.

What target year appears in the official title of the India-EU joint strategic agenda?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the acronym of the India-Middle East-Europe corridor that the agenda seeks to fast-track?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the value, in EUR billion, of the EU's Global Gateway Initiative?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the name of the European mechanism to be set up in India to streamline lawful migration for skilled professionals?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage of reciprocal tariffs did the US impose on Indian goods in August 2025? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which single word completes the phrase describing India and the EU's joint position in global trade: the '___ Pole'?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What US trade surplus figure, in USD billion, is described as exposed to potential sanctions?

Answer: _____

EU Origins and India Ties

The European Union began as a cooperation arrangement among a small group of countries and has since grown to 27 member states. It now operates through a set of institutions that together propose, decide and enforce EU policy.

India's association with the bloc is long-standing. Diplomatic ties were built with a predecessor of the present union, and relations were later raised to a strategic footing. The EU is one of India's major trade and investment partners. Summits between the two sides began in 2000. Leaders have met at summits since then.

Member states differ in size and population, and the union's membership has changed over time. The union's common border-free zone and its shared currency are both well-known features of European integration. Adoption of EU regulations, sometimes called the Brussels Effect, shapes standards for partners beyond Europe. Standards set by the union can influence exporters in other markets.

Institutional dialogue has also deepened. Its common currency is used across much of the union. India and the EU have set up several mechanisms, including a trade and technology body and a connectivity initiative linking India with Europe through the Middle East. Its climate ambition is to cut net greenhouse emissions by 55 per cent by 2030, compared with 1990 levels.

Q1.

In which year did India establish diplomatic relations with the European Economic Community, the EU's predecessor?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the first India-EU Summit held, in 2000?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was India's export value to the EU in 2024-25, in USD billion?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Since which year has the Schengen Area allowed border-free travel, according to the booklet?
(year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which EU member state has the largest population?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the India-EU Trade and Technology Council established?

Answer: _____

Demographic Winter: Key Terms Recall

China's population fell by 3.39 million in 2025, bringing the total to 1.405 billion. It was the fourth consecutive year of decline, and births dropped to 7.92 million over the same period. These figures sit within a wider pattern that the booklet calls demographic winter. The booklet notes that this pattern is no longer confined to developed countries and is now a global phenomenon. Its effects are described as reaching several areas of national life, including economic growth, public finances and the provision of care. Ageing populations are said to bring a rising fiscal burden on governments. The booklet presents a set of key indicators that help identify this phase, and it discusses the causes and negative impacts of the pattern in separate sections. This material is part of the January 2026 issue of current affairs, which covers reports, summits and indices. The chapter also includes practice questions on the main figures and terms. The topic is placed under the heading China's Population Declines for Fourth Consecutive Year, which marks the main subject of the issue. The booklet describes the phase in simple terms and links the 2025 figures to the wider trend. Readers will also find definitions of key terms at the end of the section.

Q1.

In children per woman, what replacement level of fertility is used as the benchmark for population stability?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the average number of births per woman called?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term describes the children born to a woman during her reproductive years?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term denotes the growth potential that arises from a larger working-age population compared to dependents?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Between which ages, in years, is a woman's reproductive period counted for fertility?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ratio, rising with ageing, is listed as a key indicator of demographic winter?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which age-structure shape, with a shrinking young population and an expanding elderly population, is listed as a key indicator?

Answer: _____

Causes and Impacts: Quick Recall

A decline in population growth is not explained by one factor alone. The booklet describes it as the result of several forces, and it separates these forces into causes and negative impacts. The causes relate to choices that people make about their careers, their homes and their families, along with the social setting in which those choices are made. Some causes are economic in nature, while others reflect changing attitudes towards family life. The booklet then turns to the consequences of the pattern, which it presents as pressures on several parts of society. These pressures reach the economy, the health sector and the care of people in later life. The booklet also links the pattern to the social and emotional well-being of families. Causes and impacts are set out in the same chapter, so readers can see the reasons behind the decline alongside its effects. Each cause and each impact is presented as a separate point, with its own short explanation in the text. The chapter also includes practice questions on the main figures and terms. The chapter is titled Reports, Summits, Indices and forms part of the January 2026 issue. The booklet uses the term demographic winter for the wider phase in which these causes and impacts appear.

Q1.

Which process, marked by smaller and costlier urban housing, is cited as a cause of demographic winter?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Along with healthcare and elderly care, which system's burden does an ageing population raise?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which label names the pattern in which future labour supply falls short because youth replacement is insufficient?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Smaller families disrupt traditional support systems, leading to greater isolation of which group?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which term refers to later marriages and parenthood driven by career priorities, economic insecurity and high costs?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which type of state faces youth shortages, while high-fertility states struggle with overpopulation?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which kind of country's trends show that a rebound is unlikely once fertility falls below replacement level?

Answer: _____

China's Decline: Dates and Factors

China's population has been falling for several years, and the booklet explains this through a set of connected reasons. It first points to a sharp fall in the average number of children per woman, which it describes as far below the level needed to keep a population stable. Earlier government policy forms part of the story, since birth limits were in place for a long period. The booklet also notes that the birth rate did not recover after those limits were loosened, and it treats this as evidence of deeper changes. Social and economic conditions are described as strong influences, including work pressures and the cost of living. The booklet adds that a major public health event and the economic uncertainty that followed it sped up the decline. It also says that the pressures are felt most by younger generations. Taken together, the reasons range from changes in women's lives to the effects of a global health crisis. The booklet also states that these later events accelerated the decline rather than starting it. The phrase used for the broader phase in this chapter is demographic winter, which is discussed in the earlier pages. This section of the January 2026 issue sits within the chapter titled Reports, Summits, Indices.

Q1.

In which year was China's total fertility rate 2.75, the baseline cited for the One-Child Policy's effect?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the One-Child Policy formally introduced?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did China officially end the One-Child Policy and move to the Two-Child Policy?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did China further relax its policy to allow three children?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which health crisis, linked to mortality and economic uncertainty, further accelerated China's population decline?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Higher female education and employment have enhanced women's autonomy over which kind of decisions?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which factor, named alongside high urban living costs and work-life imbalance, discourages marriage and childbearing?

Answer: _____

Fisheries Sector in India: TITA Practice

India's fisheries sector covers both capture fisheries and aquaculture, and it is supported by a range of government schemes. The National Fisheries Development Board is the nodal agency for the sector and works under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying. Its headquarters are in Hyderabad, Telangana. Fisheries is a State subject in India. The Board is involved in the Matsya Setu App, which was launched together with ICAR's Central Institute of Freshwater Aquaculture in Bhubaneswar to offer online training modules for fish farmers and stakeholders. The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana, introduced as part of the Atma Nirbhar Bharat Package, aims to modernise fisheries infrastructure and support sustainable aquaculture practices. Under it, a sub-scheme for micro and small enterprises in the sector seeks to formalise the sector under a national digital platform. The sector also includes five integrated aqua parks in several states and a plan to develop climate resilient coastal fishermen villages. A Fisheries Infrastructure Development Fund envisages infrastructure in both marine and inland fisheries, with lending through NABARD, the National Cooperative Development Corporation and scheduled banks. India's first riverine dolphin estimation was carried out to assess the population and conservation needs of river dolphins, and it recorded the highest population in Uttar Pradesh.

Q1.

What was India's total fish output in 2024-25? (in lakh tonnes)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the National Fisheries Development Board established?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many dolphins did India's first riverine dolphin estimation count? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What was the total investment for the PM Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana? (in Rs crore)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which country is the largest importer of Indian seafood?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What percentage of agriculture Gross Value Added does the fisheries sector contribute? (in %)

Answer: _____

Q7.

On which date is National Fish Farmers Day observed? (day and month)

Answer: _____

WTO Fisheries Subsidies: TITA Practice

The UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, also called the constitution for the oceans, sets out the legal framework within which all activities in the oceans and seas must be carried out. The UN High Seas Treaty, or BBNJ Agreement, is a legally binding international treaty governing ocean spaces beyond national jurisdiction. Its core objective is to safeguard biodiversity in high seas areas beyond national jurisdiction. The high seas and the international seabed area are considered global commons, open to all states for activities such as navigation, overflight and laying of submarine cables and pipelines. The International Seabed Authority works to protect the marine environment from harmful effects of deep-seabed related activities. The Commission on the Limits of the Continental Shelf helps implement the Convention on the outer limits of the continental

shelf. The WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies was adopted at the 12th Ministerial Conference. Its objective is to establish binding rules that curb harmful fisheries subsidies. The agreement prohibits support for fishing in unregulated high seas. It also requires members to submit fisheries-related data. Developing countries receive flexibility under the agreement, though within common rules. India did not join the agreement, citing the need to protect small fishers, livelihoods and food security.

Q1.

In which year was the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies adopted?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Sustainable Development Goal does the agreement support? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which month and year did the agreement enter into force?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What fraction of members had to approve the agreement for it to enter into force? (in words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which WTO fund provides aid to developing and LDC members for implementing the agreement?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Subsidies linked to which kind of fishing are prohibited? (give the acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the agreement, subsidies for fishing on which type of stocks are prohibited? (one word)

Answer: _____

PSLV-C62 payloads: typed answer practice

PSLV-C62 was a flight of the Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle, a rocket that ISRO calls its workhorse. The mission was planned for liftoff from Sriharikota, and it carried several payloads beyond its main satellite. One of these was EOS-N1, an imaging satellite that supports observation of the Earth from space. Another passenger was KID, a small prototype designed to return from space. KID was built by a startup from abroad. AayulSAT, a payload from a Bengaluru company, is a technology test linked to satellites that are already in orbit. Commercial customers from several countries also flew satellites on the mission. The PSLV is a medium-lift vehicle with a payload capability of up to 1750 kg, and its notable missions include Chandrayaan-1, the Mars Orbiter Mission and AstroSat. The Mars Orbiter Mission was the first Asian spacecraft to enter Martian orbit. ISRO is India's national space agency, and its headquarters are in Bengaluru. ISRO was formerly known as INCOSPAR and was renamed in 1969. The Indian Space Policy 2023 is the government's plan to let private enterprises carry out end-to-end activities. The Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System, known as NavIC, is another ISRO programme. The flight was ISRO's first launch in 2026, following a setback in the previous mission.

Q1.

What is the intended orbit type for EOS-N1? (orbit type)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which ocean was KID's splashdown planned? (name of ocean)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country's startup developed KID? (country)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What type of imaging does EOS-N1 perform? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What kind of payload is AayulSAT, India's first of its kind on orbit? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the term for KID's landing on the ocean, as stated for its mission? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the EOS-N1 satellite? (one word)

Answer: _____

Launch vehicles and private players: typed answer practice

ISRO's rockets fall into different families, and each has its own role. The SLV was ISRO's first satellite launch vehicle, and the ASLV followed it. The GSLV has a Mk-III version that made ISRO self-sufficient, and it is meant to carry heavier satellites deeper into space. The SSLV is one of the smaller members of that family, and its test flights have shown what it can do. The SSLV is a three-stage vehicle, and its launch site is Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota. The SSLV is produced by NSIL. The NGLV is a much larger rocket that is still being planned, with a big payload target, and it is designed to be reusable and green. On the private side, Agnikul Cosmos works on launch systems and uses a launchpad of its own. Agnikul Cosmos was founded by three people, including Srinath Ravichandran, and its engine is described as the world's first fully 3D-printed one. Another private effort is a rocket of a different design that was launched with a partner group and carried a few small satellites. The Indian Space Policy is the government's plan that opens space activity to private firms. ISRO is India's national space agency, and its headquarters are in Bengaluru.

Q1.

In which year did SSLV-D2 succeed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What does the acronym ASLV stand for?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the launchpad used by Agnikul Cosmos? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was Agnikul Cosmos founded? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the maximum payload capability of the NGLV? (in tonnes)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of India's first reusable hybrid rocket? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Agnikul Cosmos was the first company in India to sign an agreement with ISRO under which scheme? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Rules 2026 Recall

Sports administration in India is organised through national sports bodies, and the framework that governs them was strengthened recently. The stated objectives are transparency, inclusivity and accountability. Each national sports body is expected to have two organs, a General Body with a wide membership and an Executive Committee. The General Body is to include sportspersons of outstanding merit, a group defined partly by age and partly by achievement. A specified proportion of this group must be women. The Executive Committee must also have women members, and the minimum is fixed by the framework. Members hold office for a fixed term, which ends either after a set number of years or on reaching an upper age limit, whichever comes first. Bodies recognised under the framework are treated as public authorities for the purposes of information law. Separate federations govern particular sports at the national and regional levels, while the committees for the Olympic and Paralympic movements have their own responsibilities. The framework also includes a board that regulates the recognition of sports bodies. The framework applies to national sports bodies across the country, whatever the sport they govern. Together these provisions describe both the structure of national sports bodies and the qualifications of the people who serve in them.

Q1.

What is the minimum age, in years, of a Sportsperson of Outstanding Merit in the General Body?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the minimum number of women members that the Executive Committee must include?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Members serve for 3 years or up to what age, whichever is earlier? (age in years)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which committee is the sole governing body for Paralympic sports in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which Act are recognised sports bodies deemed public authorities? (Act and year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which committee is the sole governing body for Olympic sports in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What percentage of the Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit in the General Body must be women? (number, without the % sign)

Answer: _____

Initiatives Recall

Sport in India is supported by government programmes that cover different stages of an athlete's development. The National Sports Policy aims to improve the quality of training, to encourage wider participation in sport, and to increase the number of athletes who compete at the international level. Some initiatives reach the general public and encourage people to take part in fitness activities. Others concentrate on finding talent early, by searching among students across the country. A separate set of schemes focuses on athletes who already have the ability to compete for medals at the top level. Financial support for training, coaching and international competition is an important element of this support. A dedicated cell also monitors and supports the preparation of athletes for the Olympics. India's results in recent major events show the scale of this effort. Indian athletes have won medals at the Paris Olympics and the Paris Paralympics, and an Indian player has become world champion in chess at a very young age. The programmes described here operate at different levels, from broad participation to elite performance, and each has a distinct role in the wider system. Each of these measures has a specific target group, and the groups differ in age and level of performance.

Q1.

Which initiative launched in 2024 identifies talent among school children aged 9 to 18? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the TOPS scheme launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many silver medals did India win at the Paris Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who won gold in high jump at the 2024 Paris Paralympics? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which player did D Gukesh defeat in the 2024 FIDE World Chess Championship? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Mission Olympic Cell operates within which ministry? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which initiative launched in 2017 identifies and develops athletes at grassroots and elite levels? (name)

Answer: _____

Pax Silica and Critical Minerals: TITA practice

India is set to join a United States-led multilateral framework called Pax Silica, which seeks to build trusted technology supply chains. Its scope covers semiconductors, AI infrastructure, critical minerals and energy inputs, advanced manufacturing, and compute and data logistics. Member

countries include the United States, Japan, South Korea, Singapore, the United Kingdom and Israel, along with other like-minded technology partners. The framework aims to reduce over-dependence on coercive or unreliable sources and to safeguard sensitive technologies from misuse. Its trusted digital infrastructure objective promotes secure, interoperable technology networks among partner countries, and it seeks to minimise strategic vulnerabilities arising from concentrated supply chains. Within India, the National Critical Minerals Mission seeks to enhance domestic exploration, reduce import dependence and develop processing and recycling capabilities. The mission also supports overseas acquisitions of mineral assets by public sector and private companies, and it aims to enhance trade with resource-rich countries. A dedicated body, Khanij Bidesh India Ltd, is responsible for identifying and acquiring overseas assets related to critical minerals. Exploration is also extended to the Indian Ocean seabed under a separate project. The mission's key objectives further include regulatory and financial support, along with overseas acquisitions and processing capabilities. Advanced manufacturing also covers high-end hardware within the framework's scope.

Q1.

In which year did India and the US launch the Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET)? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which fiscal year does the National Critical Minerals Mission end? (format YYYY-YY)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many lithium brine blocks in Argentina has KABIL acquired exploration and exclusivity rights for? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which district is India's first lithium site, Salal-Haimana, located? (district)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Apart from Argentina and Chile, which country forms part of the lithium triangle? (country)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the project that explores the Indian Ocean seabed for critical minerals? (project name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for the National Critical Minerals Mission? (ministry)

Answer: _____

Schemes and Governance Platforms: TITA practice

India runs many schemes that combine cash support, skill training and infrastructure. Swadesh Darshan is a central sector scheme of the Ministry of Tourism that develops theme-based tourist circuits, and its second version moves towards destination-centric and sustainable tourism, with a focus on environmental sustainability and local community participation. PRASHAD focuses on infrastructure at major pilgrimage and heritage sites. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana, run by the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, gives short-term skill training to youth and recognises prior learning. An audit by the CAG of this scheme found weak planning, unspent

funds, data gaps and poor placement outcomes. A conditional cash transfer scheme supports pregnant women and lactating mothers, and it aims to improve maternal health and nutrition. PRAGATI is a monitoring platform that tracks mega projects and their timelines, and it integrates with CPGRAMS for grievances. Union government secretaries coordinate between central ministries under it, while chief secretaries of states ensure implementation at the state level. PM SVANidhi offers affordable working capital loans to street vendors, so that they can resume livelihoods, and that objective relates to disruptions caused by COVID-19 lockdowns. It is implemented by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs together with the Department of Financial Services.

Q1.

In which year was Swadesh Darshan launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was PMMVY incorporated into Mission Shakti? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many tiers does the PRAGATI platform have? (number, in words or digits)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What percentage of candidate records in the PMKVY audit had invalid or missing information? (per cent, number only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What placement rate did the PMKVY audit find? (per cent, number only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for PMMVY? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the minimum age, in years, of PMMVY beneficiaries? (years)

Answer: _____

Defence, Diplomacy and Resources: TITA practice

India and Germany have a strategic partnership that the German Chancellor's first official visit to India was held to celebrate. The visit took place in Gujarat and led to agreements on defence, trade, technology, mobility and Indo-Pacific engagement. The partnership's focus areas include technology partnerships and co-development and co-production of defence platforms. Germany announced a visa-free transit facility for Indian passport holders, and both countries seek to promote business travel and academic exchanges. In defence, DRDO works with a European organisation on the Eurodrone unmanned aerial vehicle programme. India has also developed a long-range guided rocket system called Pinaka for its army. It is a long-range artillery weapon system developed for the Indian Army. That rocket system was flight-tested from a test range, and its development involved several research laboratories. India is accelerating a hydropower project in Jammu and Kashmir called Sawalkot amid renewed tensions over the Indus Waters Treaty. A 1960 treaty governs the rivers shared with Pakistan, while the eastern rivers Ravi, Beas and Sutlej are fully available to India. India and Pakistan also exchange lists of their nuclear installations every year under an agreement that prohibits attacks on such facilities. The partnership also

includes a green and sustainable development agenda that is aligned with the Paris Climate Agreement goals.

Q1.

In which year did the India-Pakistan agreement on nuclear installations enter into force? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the approximate range, in km, of the Pinaka LRGR-120? (km)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which river is the Sawalkot hydropower project located? (river)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which Indian state is the Chandipur test range, where Pinaka was flight-tested? (state)

Answer: _____

Q5.

For how many years has the India-Germany strategic partnership been in place, as marked during Chancellor Merz's first visit? (years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Operation Pawan was launched after which accord signed on 29 July 1987? (accord name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which organisation brokered the Indus Waters Treaty of 1960? (organisation)

Answer: _____